

THE ULTIMATE SOLANA MEMECOIN GUIDE

FROM YOUR FIRST SOL TO RESEARCH, RUG-PULL
DETECTION, BUYING, TRADING, EXITING & CASHING OUT



BEGINNER FRIENDLY

RESEARCH SYSTEM

SCAM DETECTION

PRINTABLE CHECKLISTS

RISK DISCLAIMER: Memecoins are highly speculative assets. You can lose some or all of the money you invest. This guide is for educational purposes only and does not constitute financial, investment, legal, or tax advice.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

01 — SOLANA & WALLET SETUP	Pages 3-9
02 — FUNDING YOUR WALLET	Pages 10-14
03 — FINDING SOLANA MEMECOINS	Pages 15-20
04 — RUG PULL & SCAM DETECTION	Pages 21-29
05 — FULL MEMECOIN RESEARCH	Pages 30-38
06 — BUYING & EXECUTION	Pages 39-45
07 — MONITORING & EXITING	Pages 46-49
08 — CASHING OUT	Pages 50-52
09 — RISK MANAGEMENT	Pages 53-54
10 — CHECKLISTS & TOOLS	Pages 55-62
FINAL WORD & DISCLAIMER	Pages 63-63

How To Use This Guide

Parts 01-02 get you set up with a funded wallet. Parts 03-05 are the research core. Parts 06-08 cover execution and cashing out. Part 10 holds the checklists you'll reuse every time.

SOLANA & WALLET SETUP

Before you touch a single memecoin, you need to understand the network you're operating on and control a wallet that only you hold the keys to. This part builds that foundation from zero.

1.1 What Solana Is

WHAT IT IS

Solana is a public blockchain — a shared, global computer that many independent operators ("validators") run at once. It processes transactions quickly and at low cost compared to many older blockchains. Developers build applications on top of it, including the exchanges (DEXs) and token programs that memecoins run on.

WHY IT MATTERS

Almost every workflow in this guide — buying, researching, swapping, checking holders — happens because Solana is fast and cheap enough that thousands of new tokens can launch, trade, and be inspected in real time. That speed is exactly why the memecoin ecosystem on Solana is so large and so fast-moving.

1.2 Why Solana Became a Major Memecoin Ecosystem

A few practical properties of Solana pushed memecoin activity here specifically:

- **Low fees** — a typical transaction costs a fraction of a cent, so creating tokens, swapping, and experimenting is cheap.
- **Fast confirmation** — trades confirm in roughly a second, which suits the fast pace of memecoin trading.
- **Easy token creation** — the SPL token standard (explained below) and tools like Pump.fun (covered in Part 03) make launching a token simple, which means a very high volume of new tokens appear every day.
- **Concentrated attention** — because so much activity is on Solana, traders, tools, and communities cluster here, which reinforces the cycle.

Keep In Mind

Ease of creation cuts both ways. The same properties that make Solana a great place to launch a legitimate community token also make it trivial to launch a worthless or malicious one. Low friction means low quality control — the research process in this guide exists because the network itself does not filter out scams for you.

1.3 What SOL Is and What It's Used For

WHAT IT IS

SOL is Solana's native currency. It is not a memecoin — it is the base asset of the network itself, similar to how ETH is the base asset of Ethereum.

You will use SOL for three things throughout this guide:

1. **Network fees.** Every transaction (sending tokens, swapping, approving) costs a small amount of SOL, usually a fraction of a cent to a few cents.
2. **Trading currency.** Most Solana memecoins are traded directly against SOL on decentralized exchanges — you swap SOL for the memecoin, and later swap the memecoin back for SOL.
3. **Rent.** Solana requires a small SOL balance to keep accounts (including token accounts) active on the network. You'll always want to keep a small SOL cushion in your wallet beyond whatever you plan to trade with.

What Fees Actually Cost

A standard transfer or swap typically costs a small fraction of one SOL — usually well under one cent to a few cents depending on network conditions. Your wallet always shows the estimated fee before you confirm; get in the habit of glancing at it every time.

1.4 Solana Wallets

WHAT IT IS

A wallet is software (or hardware) that stores your keys and lets you sign transactions. It does not "hold" your coins in the way a bank vault holds cash — your assets live on the Solana network itself; the wallet holds the keys that prove they're yours and lets you authorize moving them.

Two wallet types matter for this guide:

TYPE	WHO CONTROLS THE KEYS	USED FOR
Custodial (exchange account)	The exchange	Buying SOL with fiat currency
Self-custody (e.g. Phantom)	You, alone	Holding, trading, and researching memecoins

Core Rule

You cannot trade Solana memecoins directly from most exchange accounts. You need a self-custody wallet you control. This is covered step-by-step in Part 02 of this section.

1.5 Tokens, SPL Tokens, and Mint Addresses

WHAT IT IS

Every asset on Solana other than SOL itself — including every memecoin — is an **SPL token** (Solana Program Library token). SPL is simply the technical standard that defines how tokens are created, transferred, and tracked on Solana. USDC, staked-SOL tokens, and every memecoin you will ever research are all SPL tokens.

WHAT IT IS

Each token has a unique **mint address** — a long string of letters and numbers that is the token's permanent, one-of-a-kind fingerprint on the network. Two tokens can share the exact same name, ticker, and logo. They can never share the same mint address.

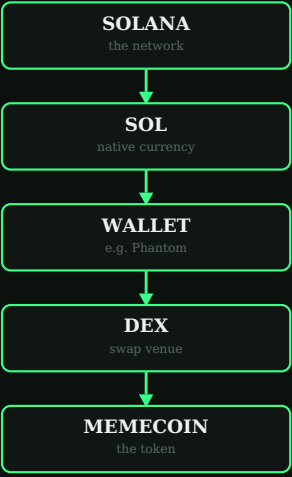
Why This Is The Single Most Important Idea In This Guide

Scammers routinely copy a popular token's name, symbol, and image and launch a fake version with a different mint address. If you buy by searching a name or ticker instead of verifying the mint address, you can buy a worthless copy while believing you bought the real token. Section 4.2 is dedicated entirely to this problem.

1.6 Solana Explorers (Preview)

A **block explorer** is a public website that lets anyone look up any wallet, transaction, or token on Solana. Think of it as a search engine for the blockchain. You will use one constantly — to verify a mint address, check who holds a token, and confirm a transaction went through. Explorers get a full walkthrough in Section 2.3; for now, just know they exist and that they show real, public, unfiltered data.

FIGURE 1.1

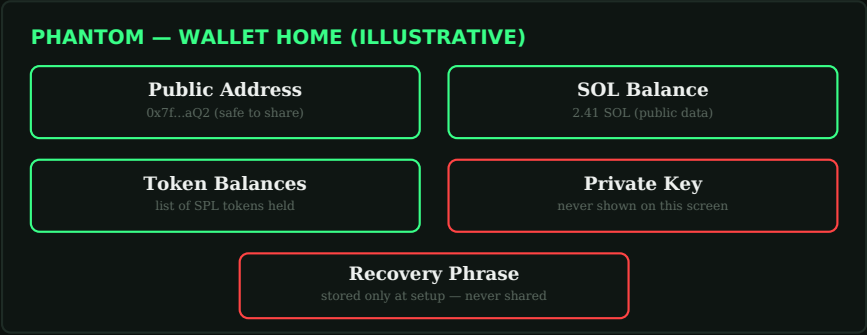


The basic stack: the Solana network carries SOL, which funds a wallet, which connects to a DEX, which is where memecoins are actually bought and sold.

1.7 Anatomy of a Wallet

Before setting one up, it helps to see all the pieces of a wallet labeled in one place.

FIGURE 1.2



The parts of a self-custody wallet. Your recovery phrase and private keys are the credentials that control it. Transaction approvals and token permissions can also create specific spending authorities, which is why you review what you sign.

ELEMENT	WHAT IT IS	SAFE TO SHARE?
Public address	Where others send you assets	Yes
SOL balance	Your SOL holdings	Yes (it's public anyway)
Token balances	Your SPL token holdings	Yes (it's public anyway)
Private key	Cryptographic key that signs transactions	Never
Recovery phrase	12–24 words that regenerate your private key	Never

Note

Everything on a blockchain is public by design. Your address, balances, and transaction history can be viewed by anyone who has your address. Privacy comes from not linking your identity to that address publicly — not from the data being hidden.

1.8 Four Words You'll Meet on an Explorer

You don't need developer-level knowledge to research safely. These four terms are the only ones you need to read an explorer page confidently.

TERM	PLAIN MEANING	WHY YOU CARE
Account	Any addressable thing: wallets, tokens, pools	Explorers organize everything by account
Program	Solana's word for a smart contract	DEXs and token logic are programs
Signature	Proof you authorized an action	Every approval you click creates one
Token account	A small account holding one token's balance	Explained just below — it affects your fees

Token Accounts — A Solana Quirk Worth Knowing

WHAT IT IS

On Solana, your wallet doesn't hold token balances directly. Instead, each token you own gets its own small **token account** linked to your wallet. When you buy a new memecoin, a token account for it is created automatically, and a very small amount of SOL is reserved to keep that account alive.

WHY IT MATTERS

This is why you'll occasionally see a slightly higher fee on the very first purchase of a given token, and why keeping a small SOL cushion matters. Some wallets let you close empty token accounts later to reclaim that reserved SOL.

1.9 Custodial vs. Self-Custody: The Trade-Off

	EXCHANGE ACCOUNT	SELF-CUSTODY WALLET
Who can freeze your funds	The exchange, or a regulator	Nobody (but see freeze authority, Section 4.3)
Forgot your password	Support can help you recover	Only your recovery phrase can restore access
If you're phished	Some protections may apply	Funds are gone, permanently
Can trade new memecoins	Rarely — only listed assets	Yes — any token on a DEX
Required for this guide	Yes, for buying SOL with fiat	Yes, for everything after that

The Honest Trade-Off

Self-custody gives you complete control and complete responsibility at the same time. There is no "forgot password" link, no fraud department, and no reversal of a mistaken or malicious transaction. Everything in Section 4.10 exists because of this.

Common Beginner Misconceptions

BELIEF	REALITY
"My coins are stored in my wallet app"	They exist on the network; the app holds your keys
"If I uninstall the app, I lose my funds"	Your recovery phrase restores everything on any device
"My wallet activity is private"	All of it is publicly visible on any explorer
"Support can reverse a bad transaction"	On-chain transactions are final and irreversible
"A verified checkmark means the token is legitimate"	Social verification says nothing about a token's mint address

1.10 Choosing a Self-Custody Wallet

WHAT IT IS

A self-custody wallet is an app where *you* generate and hold the keys — no company, exchange, or support desk can access, freeze, or recover your funds on your behalf. This guide uses **Phantom** as the worked example because it is one of the most widely used Solana wallets and has a simple beginner interface, but it is not the only reputable option.

Other established Solana-compatible wallets include Solflare, Backpack, and hardware wallets such as Ledger (used together with a software interface). The setup steps below are conceptually the same across all of them — only the screens look different.

	BROWSER EXTENSION	MOBILE APP
Best for	Using DEXs and explorers on a desktop	Trading and checking balances on the go
Connects via	A "Connect Wallet" button on websites	An in-app browser or QR/WalletConnect-style link
Beginner tip	Pin it to your browser toolbar	Only download from the official app store listing

Hardware Wallets for Larger Holdings

WHY IT MATTERS

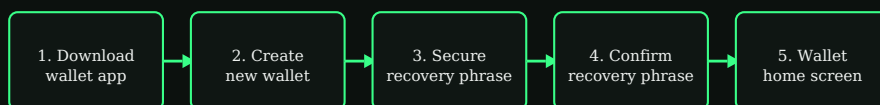
A software wallet keeps your private key on an internet-connected device. A hardware wallet keeps it on a small offline device that signs transactions without ever exposing the key to the internet. For amounts you'd be upset to lose, a hardware wallet paired with Phantom or Solflare meaningfully reduces the risk of malware or a compromised computer draining your funds.

1.11 Creating a New Wallet: Step by Step

1. Download the wallet only from its official website or your phone's official app store — search results and social media ads can lead to fake, malicious copies.
2. Choose the wallet-creation option shown by the official app. Depending on the current version, Phantom may offer more than one setup method — follow the official setup flow and securely store the recovery credentials it provides.
3. Set a strong local password. This password unlocks the app on *this device* — it does not replace or protect your recovery phrase.
4. The app will show you your recovery phrase, one time. Write it down.
5. Confirm the recovery phrase by re-entering the requested words.
6. You'll land on your wallet home screen with a SOL balance of 0.

FIGURE 1.3 — MOCK WALLET SETUP FLOW

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE



The five-screen setup flow common to most Solana wallets. Exact button placement varies by app and version.

1.12 The Recovery Phrase

Read This Twice

Your recovery phrase (12 or 24 words) is the master key to everything in your wallet. Anyone who has it can move all of your funds, from anywhere, at any time — permanently and irreversibly. No legitimate company, wallet developer, exchange, support agent, or project team will ever ask for your recovery phrase. Do not type it into a website. Do not screenshot it. Do not store it in email, cloud notes, or a password manager connected to the internet.

FIGURE 1.4 — MOCK RECOVERY PHRASE (FAKE WORDS)

NEVER USE THIS EXAMPLE — FAKE WORDS FOR ILLUSTRATION ONLY

NEVER USE THIS EXAMPLE — FAKE WORDS

1. velvet	2. orbit22	3. marble	4. cactus9
5. hollow	6. tundra	7. ripple7	8. quartz
9. meadow	10. fossil3	11. ember	12. brisk

This is a fabricated example laid out to show the typical 12-word grid format. It is not a real recovery phrase. Never use words from a guide, a website, or anything you did not generate yourself inside your own wallet app.

Where To Store It

- Write it by hand on paper (or stamp it in metal for fire/water resistance) — never store it as a plain digital file or photo.

- Store the physical copy somewhere private and secure, and consider a second copy in a separate secure location.
- Never enter it into any website, form, browser extension pop-up, or chat, under any circumstance. The only place it should ever be typed is directly into your own wallet app during setup or recovery.

1.13 Wallet Address and Connecting to Applications

Your **wallet address** (or public address) is safe to share — it's how you receive SOL and tokens, and how anyone can look your wallet up on an explorer. When a DEX or other Solana app asks you to **"Connect Wallet,"** your wallet extension will pop up asking you to approve the connection. Approving a connection lets the site see your public address and balances. It does not, by itself, let the site move your funds — that always requires a separate transaction approval, covered in Section 4.10.

Good Habit

Only connect your wallet to sites you intended to visit and whose URL you've double-checked. Disconnect from sites you're no longer using from your wallet's "Connected Apps" settings.

1.14 Wallet Comparison at a Glance

WALLET	FORM FACTOR	NOTES FOR BEGINNERS
Phantom	Browser extension + mobile	Widely used, beginner-friendly interface; used as this guide's example
Solflare	Browser extension + mobile	Long-established Solana wallet with similar core features
Backpack	Browser extension + mobile	Another established option in the Solana ecosystem
Ledger (hardware)	Physical device	Pairs with a software wallet; keys never leave the device

Choosing

Any of the reputable options above will work for everything in this guide. What matters far more than which one you pick is that you downloaded it from the official source and that your recovery phrase is stored safely offline.

1.15 The Download Trap

A Leading Cause Of Lost Funds

Fake wallet apps and fake extension listings are common. They look identical to the real thing, but the recovery phrase they generate is already known to the attacker — so every coin you ever deposit is drained, sometimes months later.

- ☐ Type the official website address in directly, or use a link you have independently verified
- ☐ Don't click sponsored search results or social media ads for wallet downloads
- ☐ On mobile, check the developer name and download count on the official app store listing
- ☐ For browser extensions, check the publisher and review count before installing
- ☐ If a "wallet" ever asks you to *enter* an existing recovery phrase to "verify," "sync," or "claim" — stop immediately

1.16 Setting Up a Separate Trading Wallet

WHY IT MATTERS

Memecoin trading involves connecting your wallet to many different websites, some of which you'll be evaluating for the first time. Keeping the balance you actively trade with separate from your longer-term holdings limits the damage if you ever connect to something malicious or approve a bad signature.

HOW TO DO IT

Most wallets let you create multiple accounts inside the same app — but for real separation, create a second, fully independent wallet with its own recovery phrase and only fund it with what you intend to trade. Move profits back to your main wallet (or an exchange) rather than letting them accumulate in the wallet that touches the most websites.

FIGURE 1.5 — WALLET SEPARATION



A small trading wallet absorbs the risk of connecting to many sites, while your main holdings stay isolated from that exposure.

Part 01 Recap

01

02

03

04

05

06

07

08

09

10

WHAT YOU SHOULD NOW BE ABLE TO DO

- ☐ Solana is a fast, low-fee blockchain; SOL is its native currency
- ☐ Your recovery phrase is the master key — offline, never shared, never typed into a website
- ☐ Every memecoin is an SPL token identified uniquely by its mint address
- ☐ Download wallets only from official sources
- ☐ Self-custody wallets give you full control and full responsibility
- ☐ Consider a separate trading wallet before you start connecting to DEXs

NEXT > PART 02 — FUNDING YOUR WALLET

FUNDING YOUR WALLET

To interact with Solana memecoins you first need SOL in a self-custody wallet. This part covers buying SOL on an exchange, moving it to your wallet safely, and verifying it arrived using an explorer.

2.1 Buying SOL on a Reputable Exchange

WHY IT MATTERS

You generally cannot buy SOL with a bank card or bank transfer directly inside a self-custody wallet. Instead, you buy SOL on a centralized exchange (where fiat currency is accepted) and then withdraw it to your own wallet.

Several large, established exchanges support SOL purchases and withdrawals, including Coinbase, Kraken, Binance, and Bybit, among others. This guide does not require you to use any single one of them.

WHAT TO DO

Choose a reputable exchange available in your country and verify that it supports SOL withdrawals on the Solana network before depositing any money.

Step by Step

1. Create an account on your chosen exchange.
2. Complete the exchange's required identity verification.
3. Deposit fiat currency (or another supported asset) using the exchange's supported methods.
4. Buy SOL — typically a simple "Buy" screen where you enter an amount.
5. Open the **Withdraw** section of the exchange.
6. Select **SOL** as the asset to withdraw.
7. Select the **Solana** network specifically (see warning below).
8. Open your self-custody wallet and copy your Solana wallet address.
9. Paste the address into the exchange's withdrawal destination field.
10. Carefully verify the first and last several characters of the pasted address match your wallet.
11. Send a small test amount first.
12. Confirm the test transaction arrived (Section 2.3 covers how).
13. Once confirmed, send the remainder.

FIGURE 2.1 — MOCK EXCHANGE BUY SCREEN

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE

BUY SOL

Asset: SOL

Amount: €100

Order Type: Market

CONFIRM BUY

A generic buy screen. Real exchange interfaces vary but follow this same basic pattern: asset, amount, order type, confirm.

FIGURE 2.2 — MOCK WITHDRAWAL SCREEN

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE

WITHDRAW

Asset: SOL

Network: SOLANA

Destination: [your wallet address]

Amount: [example amount]

NETWORK MUST MATCH

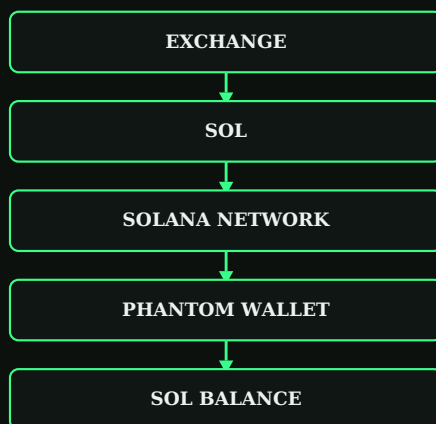
Withdrawing SOL to a self-custody wallet. Network selection is the single most important field on this screen.

Network Must Match

Many exchanges list several networks for the same asset. If you select the wrong network — or send SOL to an address that isn't a genuine Solana address — the funds can be lost permanently with no way to recover them. Always confirm the exchange's withdrawal network is set to Solana and that your wallet address was generated by a Solana-compatible wallet.

2.2 Funding Your Wallet: The Full Path

FIGURE 2.3



SOL leaves the exchange, travels over the Solana network, and lands in your wallet's SOL balance.

Minimum Practical Balance

Because every Solana transaction and token account requires a small amount of SOL for network fees and "rent," it's practical to keep a small cushion of SOL in your wallet beyond whatever amount you intend to trade with, so you're never unable to complete a transaction. Many wallets will warn you if your balance is too low to cover a pending action.

Test Transfers

Habit To Build

Whenever you're sending funds to a new address for the first time — from an exchange to your wallet, or between your own wallets — send a small test amount first, confirm it arrived, and only then send the rest. The few seconds this costs is trivial compared to the cost of an irreversible mistake.

Confirming a Transfer

After sending, the exchange will typically show a **transaction signature** (sometimes called a transaction hash) — a long string identifying that specific transfer. You can paste this signature into a Solana explorer to independently verify the transfer happened and see its status.

FIGURE 2.4 — EXAMPLE TRANSACTION LOOKUP

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE — NOT A REAL TRANSACTION

TRANSACTION LOOKUP

Signature: 5x7q...FAKE...9nZ2 (illustrative)

Status: Confirmed

Amount: 1.5 SOL

From: Exchange wallet

To: Your wallet

Pasting a transaction signature into an explorer's search bar shows its status, amount, sender, and receiver.

2.3 Solana Explorers

WHAT IT IS

A Solana explorer (such as Solscan or the official Solana Explorer) is a free public website that displays every wallet, token, and transaction on the network. You do not need an account to use one — you just paste in what you want to look up.

You can search an explorer by:

- **Wallet address** — see its SOL balance, token holdings, and full transaction history.
- **Transaction signature** — see whether a specific transaction succeeded, when, and what moved.
- **Token mint address** — see a token's total supply, holder list, authorities, and recent transfers.

FIGURE 2.5 — MOCK EXPLORER TOKEN PAGE

TOKEN OVERVIEW

Mint Address

Ex1...Fake...9qZ

Supply

998,201,442

Holders

3,204

Decimals

6

Transactions

18,442 (24h)

Transfers

live feed

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE

A token's explorer page. The fields highlighted here — mint address, supply, holders, and transactions — are exactly what you'll use throughout Parts 03-05 to research a memecoin.

YOU WANT TO KNOW...

SEARCH THE EXPLORER BY...

Did my transfer arrive?

Transaction signature, or your wallet address

Is this really the token everyone's talking about?

Token mint address

How concentrated is this token's ownership?

Token mint address → Holders tab

What has this wallet done before?

Wallet address → Transactions tab

Practice Now

Before moving on, open an explorer and search your own wallet address once your SOL arrives. Getting comfortable reading this screen now will make every research step in Parts 03-05 much faster.

2.4 Choosing an Exchange: What To Compare

Exchanges differ meaningfully by country. Rather than naming a single "best" one, compare candidates on these points:

FACTOR	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
Availability	Does it legally operate and offer service in your country?
SOL withdrawal support	Confirm it supports withdrawing SOL on the Solana network — not all listings do
Fiat deposit methods	Bank transfer, card, or local payment options you can actually use
Fee structure	Trading fee, deposit fee, and withdrawal fee — check all three
Withdrawal limits	Some accounts have daily limits depending on verification level
Track record	How long established, and its reputation for handling withdrawals reliably

WHAT TO DO

Before depositing any money, find the exchange's withdrawal page for SOL and confirm the Solana network is listed as an available withdrawal option. It's much better to discover a limitation before you've funded an account than after.

2.5 Fees You'll Actually Pay

FEE	CHARGED BY	TYPICAL SCALE
Fiat deposit fee	Exchange / payment provider	Varies widely; card deposits often cost more than bank transfers
Trading fee (buying SOL)	Exchange	A small percentage of the trade
Withdrawal fee (SOL out)	Exchange	A small flat amount of SOL
Network fee (on-chain)	Solana network	A fraction of a cent to a few cents per transaction
DEX swap fee	The DEX / liquidity providers	A small percentage built into the swap rate

Practical Note

Fees compound across many small trades. If you're making frequent small swaps, the cumulative cost can matter more than any single fee looks on its own.

2.6 Transfer Mistakes That Lose Funds Permanently

RED FLAGS & FAILURE MODES

- **Wrong network selected.** Sending SOL over a non-Solana network to a Solana address. Usually unrecoverable.
- **Clipboard hijacking malware.** Some malware silently replaces a copied wallet address with the attacker's. This is exactly why you verify the first and last characters after pasting.
- **Sending to a contract or exchange address that doesn't support the asset.** Funds may be stuck or lost.
- **Typing an address manually.** Never do this. Always copy-paste, then verify.
- **Skipping the test transfer.** The entire reason test transfers exist is to catch every mistake above cheaply.

FIGURE 2.6 — ADDRESS VERIFICATION HABIT

PASTED ADDRESS

7fQm

aQ2v

Check first 4

Check last 4

Must match your wallet exactly — defeats clipboard-swap malware

After pasting, compare the first four and last four characters against your wallet. Clipboard-replacement malware is defeated by this five-second check.

Part 02 Recap

[01](#)[02](#)[03](#)[04](#)[05](#)[06](#)[07](#)[08](#)[09](#)[10](#)

WHAT YOU SHOULD NOW BE ABLE TO DO

- ☐ Buy SOL on a reputable exchange available in your country
- ☐ Always send a small test transfer first
- ☐ Confirm SOL withdrawals on the Solana network are supported before depositing
- ☐ Verify arrival on an explorer before sending the remainder
- ☐ Copy your wallet address, paste it, and verify first and last characters
- ☐ Keep a small SOL cushion for fees and token accounts

[NEXT > PART 03 — FINDING SOLANA MEMECOINS](#)

FINDING SOLANA MEMECOINS

This part explains what a memecoin actually is, how to discover candidates using DEX Screener, and why Pump.fun is everywhere in this ecosystem — along with why this guide treats it as a source to investigate, not a place to buy blindly.

3.1 What Is a Solana Memecoin?

WHAT IT IS

A memecoin is a token whose value is driven primarily by community, narrative, and attention rather than by an underlying product or revenue stream. That doesn't make it automatically worthless or automatically valuable — it means its price behavior is driven by different forces than, say, a company's stock, and it should be evaluated with different questions.

The Vocabulary You'll Use Constantly

TERM	WHAT IT MEANS
Liquidity	The pool of assets that lets people buy and sell the token
Market cap	Token price × circulating supply
Volume	How much of the token has traded in a given period
Holders	The number of distinct wallets holding the token
Supply	The total number of tokens that exist

3.2 Why Price Alone Is Meaningless

Common Beginner Mistake

A token priced at \$0.000001 is not automatically "cheaper" or has more "room to grow" than a token priced at \$2. Price per token depends entirely on how many tokens exist.

	TOKEN A	TOKEN B
Price	\$0.000001	\$2.00
Supply	1,000,000,000,000	500,000
Market cap	\$1,000,000	\$1,000,000

Both tokens above have the identical market cap. Neither is objectively "cheaper." **Market cap** — not the per-token price — is the number that tells you the token's actual size.

3.3 Finding Memecoins Early: DEX Screener

WHAT IT IS

DEX Screener is a widely used, free website that lists tokens trading on decentralized exchanges across many blockchains, including Solana, with live price, volume, liquidity, and transaction data. It is a discovery and research tool — not a place where you buy or sell.

Key Views

- **New Pairs** — tokens that just became tradable.
- **Trending** — tokens with a recent surge in attention.
- **Gainers** — tokens with the largest recent price increases.

Key Columns

- **Volume** — trading activity over a period (e.g. 24h).
- **Liquidity** — how deep the trading pool is.
- **Market Cap** — token price × supply.

- **Transactions / Traders** – how many trades and unique wallets are active.
- **Pair age** — how long the token has been tradable.

FIGURE 3.1 — MOCK DEX SCREENER INTERFACE (SOLANA)

DEX SCREENER — CHAIN: SOLANA				
Market Cap	24h Volume	Liquidity	Pair Age	
TOKEN \$TICK1	MCAP \$820K	VOL 24H \$310K	LIO \$92K	AGE 3h
\$TICK2	\$2.1M	\$540K	\$140K	11h
\$TICK3	\$140K	\$61K	\$22K	41m

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE

Filtering by chain (Solana) and by market cap, volume, liquidity, and age narrows thousands of tokens down to a manageable shortlist to research individually.

3.4 Example Beginner Research Presets

Read Before Using These

These are example filter starting points for building a research shortlist — they are not recommendations and not guaranteed winning settings. A token passing these filters still requires the full research process in Parts 04-05 before any decision. Changing numbers does not change risk into safety.

PRESET	MARKET CAP	24H VOLUME	LIQUIDITY	NOTES
A — Early Discovery	\$40K-\$5M	\$100K+	\$30K+	Prefer newer pairs, investigate individually
B — More Established	\$250K-\$10M	\$250K+	\$75K+	Generally more trading history to review
C — Very Early / Very High Risk	\$40K-\$1M	\$25K+	\$15K+	Least information available; highest risk

Use a preset to generate a *shortlist*, then run every candidate through the full research system in Part 05 before doing anything else.

3.5 Pump.fun — Why You Keep Seeing It

WHAT IT IS

Pump.fun is a Solana launchpad that lets anyone create a new token in minutes with minimal technical knowledge. It is a major reason so many new Solana memecoins appear every single day.

Bonding Curves, in Plain Language

WHY IT MATTERS

Tokens launched on Pump.fun start trading against an automated pricing formula called a **bonding curve**, rather than against a traditional liquidity pool. As more people buy, the price rises along the curve; as people sell, it falls. Once enough SOL has been raised on the curve, the token "**graduates**" — its liquidity moves onto a standard DEX (on Solana, commonly PumpSwap), where it trades like any other listed token.

FIGURE 3.2 — SIMPLIFIED EDUCATIONAL DIAGRAM



A simplified view of the Pump.fun lifecycle. Real trading activity is far less linear than this diagram suggests.

HOW THIS GUIDE USES PUMP.FUN

This guide does not use Pump.fun as the primary buying workflow for beginners. Freshly launched tokens on any bonding curve have almost no history to research — no holder pattern, no liquidity depth to assess, no community track record. This guide uses a research-first process instead. You should not simply buy the newest Pump.fun launch.

If you do discover a token through Pump.fun that interests you, treat it exactly like any other candidate and investigate before acting:

- ☐ Mint address, verified independently
- ☐ Creator / deployer wallet history
- ☐ Holder distribution
- ☐ Liquidity depth (especially post-graduation)
- ☐ Trading activity and traders, not just volume
- ☐ Official socials and community
- ☐ Narrative — does it make sense, or is it purely manufactured hype
- ☐ Realistic exit liquidity if you needed to sell
- ☐ Token authorities, where applicable (Section 4.3)

3.6 Reading a DEX Screener Token Page

Once a token passes your filter and you click into it, you're looking at a detail page. Here's what each area actually tells you.

AREA	WHAT IT TELLS YOU	WHAT TO BE CAREFUL ABOUT
Price chart	Recent price action across timeframes	Very short histories are easy to misread
Liquidity	Depth of the trading pool	Can be removed; check lock status separately
FDV vs Market Cap	Valuation using total vs circulating supply	A large gap means significant supply not yet circulating
Txns (buys/sells)	Trade counts in a period	Counts can be inflated by wash trading
Makers / traders	Unique wallets trading	More meaningful than raw transaction count
Pair created	How long it's been tradable	Very new = very little to research
Socials / links	Project-submitted links	Submitted by whoever made the pair — verify independently

Important

Links shown on an aggregator are supplied by the token's creator and are not verified endorsements. Always cross-check a mint address against official sources before trusting any link you find on a listing page.

3.7 Volume vs. Traders: Spotting Wash Trading

WHAT IT IS

Wash trading is when coordinated wallets repeatedly buy and sell the same token to each other, creating the appearance of heavy demand without any real outside interest.

HOW TO CHECK IT

- Compare volume against the number of *unique traders* — huge volume from very few wallets is a warning sign.
- Look at whether buys and sells are suspiciously balanced and evenly spaced.
- Check the transaction feed on an explorer for repetitive, near-identical trade sizes.
- Look for volume that spikes and stops abruptly rather than tapering naturally.

3.8 Building a Shortlist That You Can Actually Work Through

Discovery generates far more candidates than anyone can research properly. A workable process:

1. Apply one of the presets from Section 3.4 to get a raw list.
2. Use a quick first pass to eliminate obvious failures — no liquidity, no credible sources, extreme holder concentration, or other immediate red flags. Don't spend full research time on candidates that fail at a glance.
3. Keep no more than three to five survivors for full research.
4. Run each survivor through the complete 11-step system in Part 05.
5. Expect most, and often all, of them to be eliminated. That is the system working correctly, not a failure.

Mindset

The purpose of discovery is not to find something to buy today. It's to build a pipeline of candidates that you reject efficiently, so that the rare token you do act on has actually earned it.

3.9 Memecoin Narratives

Narrative is the story that gives a memecoin a reason to spread. Common categories:

- Animal / mascot themes
- Internet culture and viral moments
- Parody of existing projects
- Community in-jokes
- Current events references
- Nostalgia themes
- AI, tech, or ecosystem themes
- Pure "ticker aesthetics" with no story

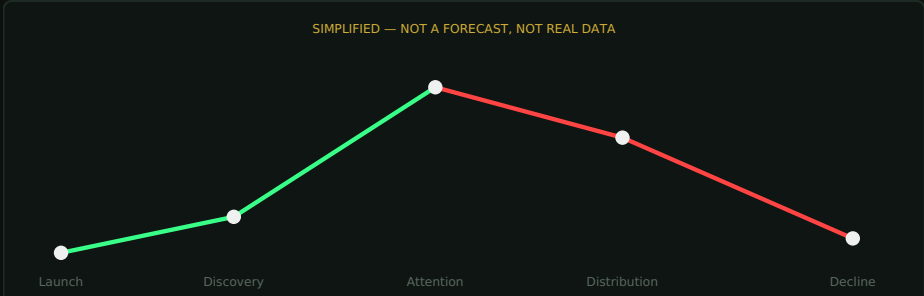
NARRATIVE RED FLAGS

- A near-identical copy of a token that trended yesterday, with a slightly changed name
- A story that only exists in paid promotional posts, not in organic community talk
- Claims of partnerships, listings, or endorsements with no verifiable source
- Narrative that changes completely every few days to chase whatever is trending

3.10 The Typical Memecoin Lifecycle

Understanding the general shape of how these tokens behave helps you interpret where a token might be when you find it. This is a descriptive pattern, not a prediction — many tokens never progress past stage one, and the pattern is not reliable.

FIGURE 3.3 — GENERALIZED LIFECYCLE (ILLUSTRATIVE)



A simplified illustration of phases often observed in memecoin activity. Most tokens fail early. This diagram is not a forecast and should not be used to time entries or exits.

PHASE	WHAT'S HAPPENING	RISK PROFILE
Launch	Token created, minimal liquidity, almost no data	Extreme — insiders and snipers dominate
Discovery	First outside buyers, socials appear	Very high — little history to verify
Attention	Volume and holders grow, narrative spreads	High — also when hype is most manufactured
Distribution	Early holders sell into new demand	High — watch for holder concentration shifts
Decline or persistence	Most fade; a small number retain a community	Liquidity often deteriorates quickly

Do Not Read This As A Strategy

Nothing here tells you which phase a given token is in at the moment you're looking at it, and the phases do not occur reliably or in order. Use this only as vocabulary for describing what you observe, never as a basis for timing a trade.

3.11 Where Else Memecoins Surface

SOURCE	USEFUL FOR	CAUTION
DEX Screener / aggregators	Systematic, filterable discovery	Listing is not vetting
Launchpads (e.g. Pump.fun)	Seeing tokens at the earliest stage	Almost no data to research
X / Twitter	Narrative and community signals	Heavily gamed by paid promotion
Telegram / Discord "calls"	Early awareness	Frequently coordinated exit liquidity schemes
Influencer posts	Attention indicator	Often paid; disclosure is rare

On "Calls" And Influencers

If someone is telling a large audience to buy a token, consider who benefits from that audience buying. Being early to a promoted token often means being the demand that someone else sells into. Never treat a recommendation as a substitute for your own research.

Part 03 Recap

- 01
- 02
- 03
- 04
- 05
- 06
- 07
- 08
- 09
- 10

WHAT YOU SHOULD NOW BE ABLE TO DO

- ☐

Market cap, not price per token, tells you a token's size
- ☐

DEX Screener filters produce candidates — never conclusions
- ☐

Compare volume against unique traders to spot manufactured activity
- ☐

Understand Pump.fun's bonding curve and graduation, but don't buy the newest launch blindly
- ☐

Keep your shortlist small enough to research each candidate properly
- ☐

Narrative matters, but a narrative that only exists in paid posts is not a narrative

NEXT > PART 04 — RUG PULL & SCAM DETECTION

RUG PULL & SCAM DETECTION

This is the most important part of the guide. It covers how to tell real community interest from manufactured hype, how to confirm you have the genuine token, and how to read the Solana-specific signals — authorities, holders, liquidity — that separate a survivable risk from a near-certain scam.

4.1 Community & Hype

Memecoins live and die on attention. Learning to tell genuine interest from manufactured hype is a core skill.

What To Research

- X / Twitter
 - Telegram
 - Discord
- Official website
 - Community chat activity
 - Who is promoting it, and why

Real Hype vs. Fake Hype

REAL HYPE	FAKE HYPE
Genuine, varied conversations	Thousands of followers, almost no engagement
Original memes and community-made content	Identical, copy-pasted comments
Organic replies from real accounts	Bot-like accounts, spam replies
Consistent posting over time	Paid shilling bursts, then silence
Growing, varied engagement	Fake partnership or celebrity claims
Members can discuss it without being told to shill	"100X GUARANTEED," constant urgency, "buy now or miss everything"

FIGURE 4.1 — MOCK X / TWITTER PROFILE REVIEW

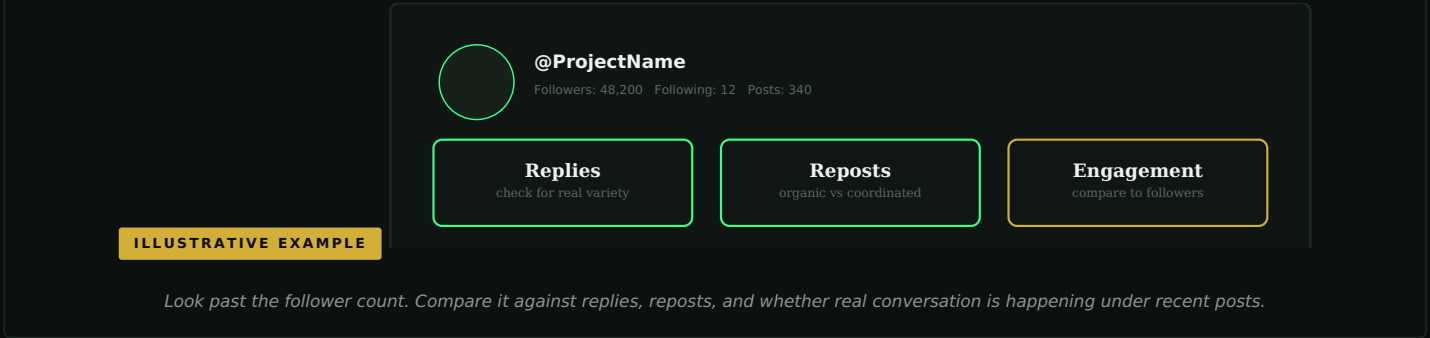


FIGURE 4.3 — WEBSITE DUE-DILIGENCE CHECK

Contract Address stated plainly	Official Socials linked, matching	Docs / Team Info present where relevant
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A legitimate project's site typically states its contract address plainly, links to real official social accounts, and (where relevant) documentation or team information.

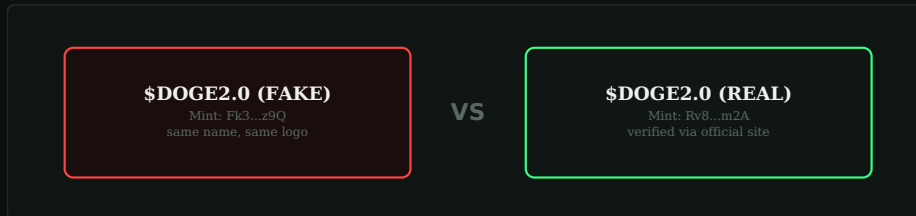
4.2 Finding the Real Contract

The Core Rule Of This Section

Ticker is not a unique identifier. Name is not proof. Logo is not proof. On Solana, the mint address is the only thing that uniquely identifies a token.

Anyone can launch a token called "DOGE2.0" with a dog logo an hour after a genuine "DOGE2.0" starts trending. Search engines and social media will show you both. Only the mint address tells them apart.

FIGURE 4.4



Same name, same logo, same ticker — completely different mint addresses. Only one is the token the community actually trades.

How To Verify You Have the Real One

1. Get the mint address from the project's official website or pinned social post — not from a random link, comment, or DM.
2. Cross-check that same mint address against a second independent source (e.g. the project's Telegram announcement channel).
3. Paste the mint address into a Solana explorer and confirm the metadata (name, symbol, supply) matches what you expect.
4. Confirm the same mint address is what's actually listed on DEX Screener before you swap.

4.3 Solana-Specific Rug Pull Research

This is the core technical defense against scams. Every one of the following should be checked, every time, before buying.

Mint Authority & Freeze Authority

WHAT IT IS

Mint authority is the ability to create additional tokens beyond the current supply. **Freeze authority** is the ability to freeze a specific wallet's token account, preventing it from being transferred. Both are visible on a token's explorer page.

RED FLAGS

An active mint authority means the supply could be inflated at any time, diluting existing holders. An active freeze authority means holders' tokens could theoretically be frozen. Many legitimate projects renounce (permanently disable) both.

Unknown = Unknown

An active authority is not automatic proof of malicious intent — some legitimate projects retain authorities temporarily for operational reasons. But it is a real, verifiable risk factor that should raise your scrutiny, not something to wave away. Treat "I couldn't verify this" as a reason for caution, not a detail to skip.

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE

Mint Authority Renounced / Active?	Freeze Authority Renounced / Active?
Supply 998,201,442	Decimals 6
Holders 3,204	Mint Address Ex1...Fake...9qZ

Mint authority, freeze authority, supply, decimals, holders, and the mint address — the core facts you check before going any further.

Creator / Deployer Wallet Behavior

HOW TO CHECK IT

Look up the wallet that deployed the token on an explorer. Check its transaction history: has it deployed many other tokens before? Did it immediately sell a large amount right after launch? A wallet with a pattern of repeated launches followed by immediate large sells is a strong warning sign.

Wallet Clusters, Sniper Behavior, and Insider Accumulation

WHAT IT IS

"Sniper" wallets buy within seconds of a token launching, often using automated tools, before most people even see it. "Wallet clusters" are groups of separate-looking wallets that are actually coordinated (e.g. all funded from the same source, all buying and selling in sync). Both can indicate insiders positioning themselves to sell into the attention retail buyers bring later.

RED FLAGS

- A handful of wallets acquiring a large share of supply within the first minute
- Many holder wallets funded from the same source wallet
- Sudden concentration spikes with no clear public reason
- Suspicious transfer patterns between "unrelated" top holders

4.4 Holder Analysis

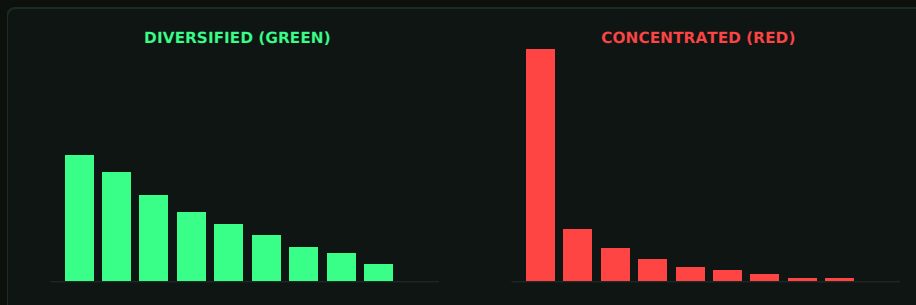
Check the **Holders** tab on the token's explorer page.

- **Top holders** — the largest wallets and what percentage of supply each controls.
- **Creator wallet** — how much of the supply the deployer still holds.
- **Liquidity pool** — the pool itself will appear as a large "holder"; this is expected and different from a personal wallet holding a large share.
- **Burn address** — tokens sent here are permanently removed from circulation.
- **Exchange wallets** — large balances at known exchange addresses.

Holder Count Is Misleading Alone

10,000 holders can still be a dangerous position if five wallets control 70% of the supply between them. Always check concentration, not just the headline holder count.

FIGURE 4.6 — HOLDER DISTRIBUTION



Green: supply spread across many independent holders. Red: supply concentrated in a handful of wallets — a single one of them selling can crash the price.

4.5 Liquidity

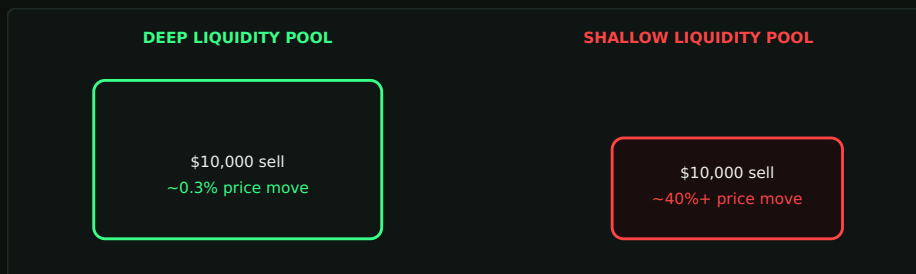
WHAT IT IS

Liquidity is the pool of paired assets (e.g. SOL and the token) sitting in the trading pair that lets buy and sell orders actually execute. It is, in a very real sense, your exit door — without it, there is no way to sell.

WHY IT MATTERS

Low liquidity means even a modest sell order can move the price sharply against you (**price impact**), and means the gap between the price you expect and the price you get (**slippage**) can be large. Both are explained in full in Section 6.3.

FIGURE 4.7 — LIQUIDITY DEPTH COMPARISON



The same \$10,000 sell order barely moves the price in a deep liquidity pool, but can crash the price in a shallow one.

Liquidity Concentration & Removal Risk

RED FLAGS

- Liquidity that is extremely small relative to the token's market cap
- Liquidity pool tokens not locked or burned, meaning whoever controls them could remove the liquidity at any time (a classic "rug pull")
- A single wallet controlling most of the liquidity provision
- Liquidity that has been quietly shrinking over time

4.6 A Quick Reference: Common Scam Patterns

PATTERN	WHAT HAPPENS
Classic rug pull	Deployer removes liquidity or dumps a large held position, price collapses toward zero
Honeypot	Buying works, but selling is blocked or heavily restricted by the token's code or permissions
Fake token / impersonation	A copycat token reuses a popular name, ticker, and logo with a different mint address
Wash trading	Coordinated wallets trade with each other to fake volume and activity
Bot-inflated socials	Purchased followers and engagement fake the appearance of a real community

Carry This Forward

None of these checks work in isolation. A token can pass one check and fail another. Part 05 packages all of these signals into a single repeatable research system.

4.7 Honeypots: When You Can Buy But Not Sell

WHAT IT IS

A honeypot is a token engineered so that buying succeeds normally, but selling fails or is heavily restricted for ordinary holders. The chart looks like it only goes up — because almost nobody can actually sell.

HOW TO CHECK IT

- Look at the transaction feed: are there real, successful sell transactions from many different wallets, or almost exclusively buys?
- Check whether an active freeze authority exists (Section 4.3).
- Be suspicious of a chart with an unnaturally smooth, uninterrupted rise.
- Consider that a token with a sell-side that only ever shows the same few wallets may be restricting everyone else.

No Tool Is Definitive

Various third-party scanners claim to detect honeypots automatically. They can be useful as one signal, but they can produce both false positives and false negatives, and scammers actively design around them. Never treat a green checkmark from any automated scanner as proof a token is safe.

4.8 Reading a Holder List Properly

Open the token's Holders tab on an explorer and work down the list systematically.

WHAT YOU SEE	HOW TO INTERPRET IT
Top holder is the liquidity pool	Expected and normal — identify it so you don't miscount it as a whale
Top holder is the burn address	Those tokens are permanently removed from circulation
Creator wallet holds a large share	Significant risk — they can sell into your buy at any time
Top 10 wallets hold a large combined share	Concentration risk; any one of them can move the price sharply
Many wallets with near-identical balances	Possible cluster — one entity splitting holdings across wallets
Wallets funded from the same source	Strong cluster signal; check funding history on the explorer

HOW TO TRACE A CLUSTER

Click into a suspicious top holder's wallet on the explorer and look at where its SOL came from. If several "independent" top holders were all funded by the same wallet shortly before the token launched, they are very likely coordinated.

4.9 Liquidity Lock Status

WHAT IT IS

When someone provides liquidity to a pool, they receive LP tokens representing their share. Whoever holds those LP tokens can withdraw the liquidity. "Locking" means those LP tokens are placed in a time-locked contract; "burning" means they're permanently destroyed, making the liquidity unremovable.

WHY IT MATTERS

If the deployer holds unlocked LP tokens, they can remove the entire liquidity pool at any moment, leaving holders with a token that cannot be sold at any meaningful price. This is the mechanical definition of a classic rug pull.

Unknown = Unknown

Locked or burned liquidity removes one specific risk. It does not make a token safe. A token can have permanently burned liquidity and still collapse because holders sell, the narrative dies, or an insider dumps a large position. Never let a single green signal override everything else you found.

4.10 Dangerous Signatures & Token Permissions

WHAT IT IS

Every action you take on-chain requires you to approve a request in your wallet. Most are routine. Some grant broad permissions or transfer assets outright — and malicious sites are designed to make the dangerous ones look routine.

REQUEST TYPE	WHAT IT DOES	RISK LEVEL
Connect wallet	Lets a site see your public address and balances	Low
Message signature	Proves you control the wallet (e.g. logging in)	Low, but read what it says
Swap transaction	Exchanges a specific amount of one token for another	Normal — verify the amounts
Token approval / delegate	Grants another account permission over your tokens	High — scrutinize carefully
Unclear / unreadable request	You can't tell what it does	Do not approve

WHAT TO DO

- Read every request before approving. If your wallet shows a warning, take it seriously.
- If a request appeared without you initiating an action, reject it.
- If a site asks you to sign repeatedly for one simple action, stop and reassess.
- Periodically review and revoke old token approvals and connected sites in your wallet settings.

4.11 Social Engineering Attacks

PATTERNS TO RECOGNIZE INSTANTLY

- **Fake support.** You post a problem publicly; several "support" accounts DM you within minutes. Real support never DMs first and never asks for a recovery phrase.
- **Fake airdrops.** Unknown tokens appear in your wallet with a website link. Interacting with them can prompt malicious signature requests. Ignore them.
- **Impersonation.** Accounts copying a project's exact name and avatar, posting a fake contract address in replies to real announcements.
- **Urgency.** "Presale ends in 10 minutes." Urgency exists to stop you from researching.
- **Compromised accounts.** Even a genuine project's account can be hacked — cross-check any surprise contract address against a second source.

4.12 The Red Flag Scorecard

No single item below is proof of a scam, and no clean scorecard is proof of safety. Use it to force yourself to look at everything before deciding.

SIGNAL	CONCERNING WHEN...
Mint authority	Still active, with no clear stated reason
Freeze authority	Still active
Liquidity	Very small relative to market cap, or unlocked
Holder concentration	A few non-pool wallets control a large combined share
Creator wallet	History of repeated launches followed by fast, large sells
Volume	High volume from very few unique traders
Socials	Large follower counts with near-zero real engagement
Community	Identical messages, heavy urgency, bans on questions
Website	No contract address, broken links, copied content
Sell activity	Almost no successful sells from ordinary wallets

How To Use It

Count how many rows you can't clear. One unresolved item is a reason for caution. Several is a reason to walk away. "I couldn't find out" counts as unresolved — unknown is unknown.

4.13 Anatomy of a Rug Pull, Step by Step

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE — GENERIC PATTERN, NOT A REAL EVENT

Understanding the sequence makes the warning signs recognizable while they're still early enough to matter.

STAGE	WHAT THE OPERATOR DOES	WHAT YOU COULD HAVE SEEN
1. Preparation	Funds several wallets from one source	Cluster pattern visible in funding history on the explorer
2. Launch	Deploys token, seeds modest liquidity	LP tokens not locked or burned
3. Capture	Prepared wallets buy immediately at the lowest prices	Large share of supply acquired within the first minutes
4. Promotion	Paid posts, bot replies, manufactured urgency	Huge follower counts, near-zero genuine engagement
5. Inflow	Outside buyers arrive, price rises	Volume rising while unique trader count lags
6. Exit	Insiders sell, and/or liquidity is removed	Sudden concentration change, then liquidity collapse
7. Abandonment	Socials deleted, group closed	Nothing left to research, and no exit liquidity

THE POINT OF THIS TABLE

Every single "what you could have seen" entry is checkable before you buy, using the explorer and pair-page skills from Parts 02 and 03. The information is public. The research process in Part 05 exists to make sure you actually look at it.

4.14 Why Automated Safety Scores Aren't Enough

Various tools assign tokens a safety score or a set of green checkmarks. They're worth glancing at, but understand their limits:

- They typically check a narrow set of technical conditions (authorities, LP status) and cannot assess narrative, community authenticity, or wallet coordination.
- Scammers design launches specifically to produce a clean score.
- A clean score on a token with a coordinated holder cluster is still a dangerous token.
- Scores can be out of date relative to a fast-changing on-chain situation.

Use Them As One Input

Treat any automated score exactly as you'd treat a single filter result: a starting point that tells you where to look, never a verdict. Your own checks across authorities, liquidity, holders, volume quality, and community are what actually form the picture.

4.15 Quick Reference: Where To Check What

YOU WANT TO CHECK...	GO TO...	LOOK FOR...
Mint address is genuine	Official site + pinned social post + explorer	Same address across all independent sources
Mint / freeze authority	Explorer token page	Renounced vs active status
Supply and decimals	Explorer token page	Whether supply matches project claims
Holder concentration	Explorer holders tab	Top 10 share excluding pool and burn addresses
Wallet clusters	Explorer, individual holder wallets	Common funding source before launch
Creator behavior	Explorer, deployer wallet	Prior launches; fast large sells
Liquidity depth	Pair page on an aggregator	Size relative to market cap; trend over time
LP lock / burn	Explorer + project documentation	Whether LP tokens can still be withdrawn
Volume quality	Pair page	Volume vs unique traders; buy/sell balance
Real sells occurring	Explorer transaction feed	Successful sells from many different wallets
Community authenticity	X, Telegram, Discord	Varied organic conversation vs identical replies
Website legitimacy	Official site	Contract address stated; working links; real content

Print This One

This table and the master checklist in Part 10 are the two pages worth keeping open in a second window every time you research a token.

Part 04 Recap

[01](#)[02](#)[03](#)[04](#)[05](#)[06](#)[07](#)[08](#)[09](#)[10](#)

WHAT YOU SHOULD NOW BE ABLE TO DO

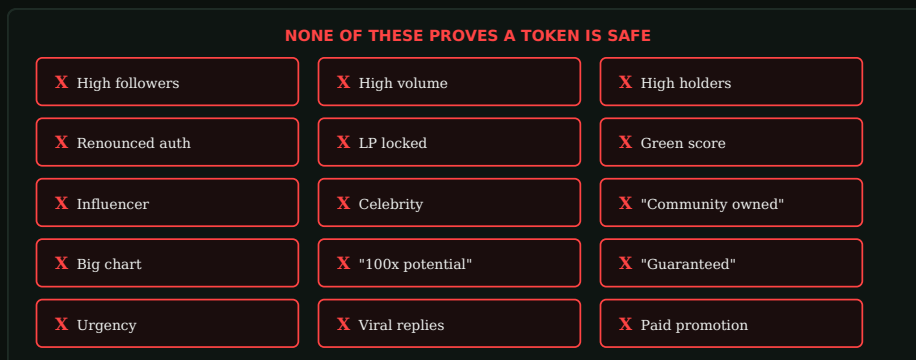
- ☐ The mint address is the only unique identifier — verify it from multiple independent sources
- ☐ Trace suspicious top holders back to a common funding source
- ☐ Check mint and freeze authority on every token, every time
- ☐ Follower counts are purchasable; genuine engagement is much harder to fake
- ☐ Holder count means nothing without concentration analysis
- ☐ Automated safety scores are one input, never a verdict
- ☐ Liquidity is your exit door; check depth and whether it can be removed
- ☐ Unknown means unknown — treat it as a reason for caution, not a detail to skip

NEXT > [PART 05 — FULL MEMECOIN RESEARCH](#)

4.16 What Does Not Prove a Token Is Safe

Each item below is routinely presented — by promoters, by other traders, and sometimes by tools — as evidence that a token is trustworthy. None of them is. Every one can be bought, faked, or reversed.

FIGURE 4.8 — FALSE SAFETY SIGNALS



Fifteen signals that are commonly mistaken for proof of safety. Any of them can be present on a token that fails completely.

CLAIMED PROOF	WHY IT PROVES NOTHING
High follower count	Followers are purchasable in bulk; engagement is far harder to fake
High volume alone	Coordinated wallets can generate volume with no outside demand
High holder count alone	10,000 holders means nothing if a handful of wallets control the supply
Renounced authority alone	Removes one risk; liquidity removal and insider selling remain possible
LP locked alone	Locked liquidity cannot stop holders from selling or a narrative from dying
Green automated safety score	Checks a narrow technical set; scammers design launches to score well
Influencer recommendation	Promotion is frequently paid and rarely disclosed
Celebrity endorsement	Often fabricated outright, or an account that was compromised
"Community owned" claim	A claim anyone can type; verify holder distribution instead
An impressive chart	A rising line can also mean nobody is able to sell
"100x potential"	A prediction presented as a fact; no one can know this
"Guaranteed"	Nothing in this asset class is guaranteed — treat the word as disqualifying
Urgency	Deadlines exist to stop you completing your research
Viral replies	Reply volume is the single easiest metric to manufacture
Paid promotion	Measures a marketing budget, not a token's quality

The Rule

No single green signal proves a token is safe. Safety is never established by one check passing — only by the whole picture holding up under the eleven-step system, and even then the token remains a highly speculative asset that can lose all of its value.

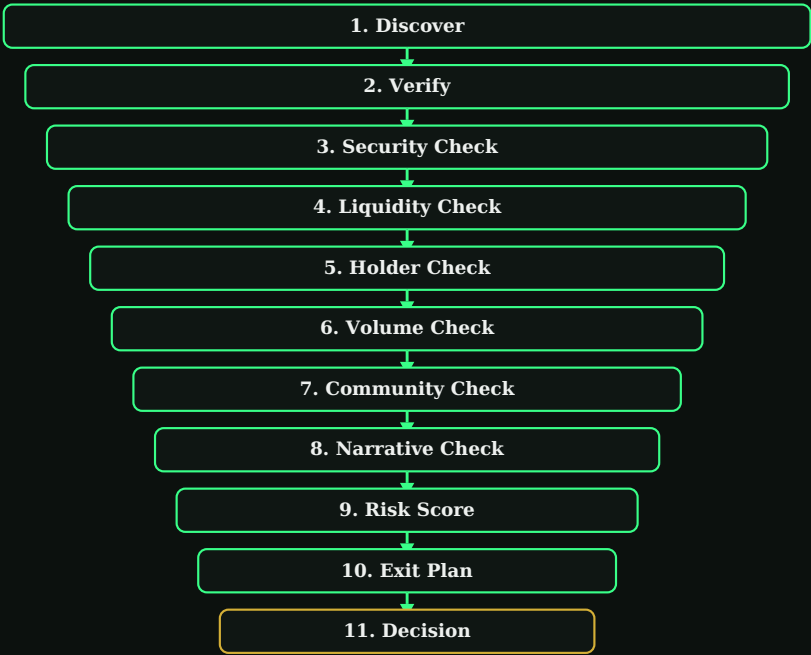
FULL MEMECOIN RESEARCH SYSTEM

Everything from Parts 03 and 04 combines into one repeatable process here, plus the beginner-level chart-reading skills you need to understand what you're looking at once you open a token's price chart.

5.1 The 11-Step Solana Memecoin Research System

This is the core of the guide. Everything in Parts 03 and 04 exists to feed these eleven steps, and everything in Parts 06 and 07 assumes you have completed them.

FIGURE 5.1 — THE RESEARCH FUNNEL



The funnel narrows deliberately. Most candidates should be eliminated in the first five steps, and reaching step 11 is uncommon.

The Principle That Holds The System Together

Passing one check does not make a token safe. The steps are cumulative, not alternatives — a token that clears steps 2 and 3 brilliantly and fails step 5 has failed.

#	STEP	THE QUESTION IT ANSWERS	COVERED IN
01	Discover	Is this worth any of my time at all?	Section 3.3
02	Verify	Am I even looking at the right token?	Section 4.2
03	Security	Can supply be inflated or my wallet frozen?	Section 4.3
04	Liquidity	Could I actually get out, and can the pool be pulled?	Sections 4.5, 4.9
05	Holders	Who controls the supply, and are they coordinated?	Sections 4.4, 4.8
06	Volume	Is the activity real or manufactured?	Section 3.7
07	Community	Does anyone genuinely care about this?	Section 4.1
08	Narrative	Is there a coherent reason people care?	Section 3.9
09	Risk score	What did I find, and what is still unresolved?	Section 4.12
10	Exit plan	How and when would I get out?	Section 7.2
11	Decision	Buy, watch, or walk away?	Section 10.1

WHY THE ORDER MATTERS

The steps are sequenced so the cheapest, most decisive checks come first. Verifying a mint address takes seconds and eliminates impersonation outright; assessing a narrative takes far longer and is worthless if you were researching the wrong token all along. Work in order and you waste the least effort on candidates that were never viable.

Unknown = Unknown

When a step cannot be resolved — a source you cannot find, an authority you cannot confirm, a wallet you cannot trace — do not record it as safe, and do not assume malice without evidence. Record it as unresolved. Unresolved information is itself a reason to increase caution, and several unresolved steps together are a reason to walk away.

Keep A Record

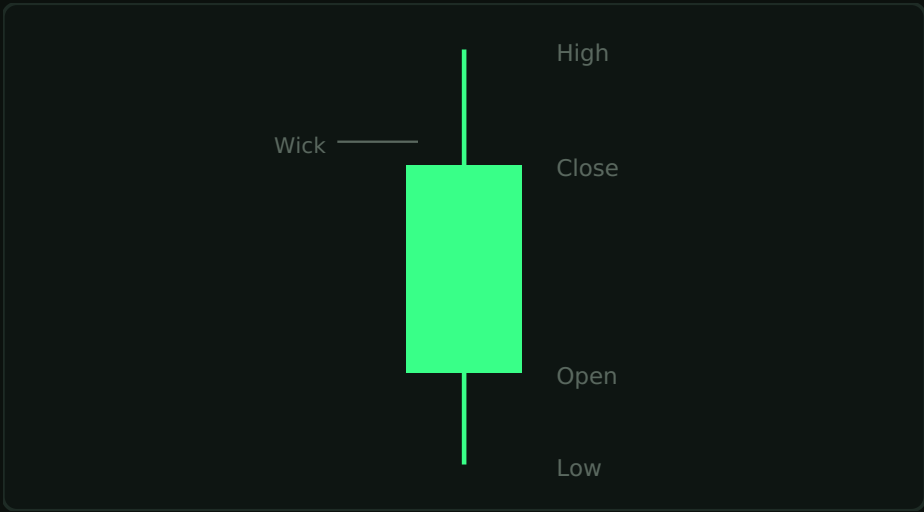
Use one research sheet per candidate so your findings survive past the session. A printable template is provided in Section 10.10.

5.2 Chart Reading for Complete Beginners

You do not need advanced technical analysis to use a memecoin's price chart. You need to understand what a candle represents and recognize a handful of basic patterns.

Anatomy of a Candle

FIGURE 5.2 — ANNOTATED CANDLESTICK



Each candle shows four prices for its time period: open, high, low, and close. A green candle closed higher than it opened; a red candle closed lower.

TERM	MEANING
Open	Price at the start of the time period
Close	Price at the end of the time period
High / Low	Highest and lowest price reached during the period
Wick	The thin line showing the high/low extremes beyond the open/close body
Volume	How much was traded during that period, usually shown as bars below the chart

Trend Basics

Uptrend: a pattern of higher highs and higher lows — each peak and each dip is higher than the last. **Downtrend:** a pattern of lower highs and lower lows — each peak and each dip is lower than the last.

Support, Resistance, Breakouts, Pullbacks

- **Support** — a price level where buying pressure has repeatedly stopped a decline.

- **Resistance** — a price level where selling pressure has repeatedly stopped a rise.
- **Breakout** — price moving decisively past a resistance (or support) level.
- **Pullback** — a short-term move against the broader trend before it potentially continues.

FIGURE 5.3 — TREND, SUPPORT & RESISTANCE



A simplified chart showing an uptrend bouncing off a support level and breaking through resistance. Real memecoin charts are far more volatile than this.

Volatility Warning

Solana memecoins routinely move 20-80% or more in a single day, in either direction. Chart patterns here are far less reliable than in traditional, deeper markets. Treat chart reading as one input among many, not a predictive tool.

5.3 Let's Research a Solana Memecoin

FICTIONAL EXAMPLE — CREATED FOR EDUCATIONAL PURPOSES

This walkthrough applies all eleven steps to an invented token so you can see the process end to end. **\$NOVA does not exist.** Every figure, wallet, and screen below was fabricated to teach the method. Nothing here describes a real token, a real outcome, or a real opportunity.

Step 1 — Discover

\$NOVA appears on a DEX Screener Solana list under Preset A. Surface figures: market cap around \$780K, 24h volume around \$340K, liquidity around \$61K, pair age roughly nine hours. It clears the filter, so it becomes a candidate — nothing more than that.

Step 2 — Verify the Mint Address

The project website lists a mint address. The pinned post on its X account lists the same address. The pair page on DEX Screener matches both. Three independent sources agree.

RESULT

PASS. The mint address is consistent across sources, so we know which token we are actually researching.

Step 3 — Security: Mint and Freeze Authority

The explorer token page shows mint authority renounced and freeze authority renounced. Supply is fixed and cannot be inflated; no wallet can be frozen.

RESULT

PASS — but only on these two specific risks. This is the point where many beginners stop researching. We are two steps into eleven.

Step 4 — Liquidity

Liquidity sits around \$61K against a market cap near \$780K. Checking the LP position, the liquidity tokens do not appear locked or burned, and one wallet supplied nearly all of it.

RESULT

CONCERN. Liquidity is thin relative to market cap, and whoever controls those LP tokens could withdraw the pool. That is the mechanical setup for a rug pull, whether or not it is ever used.

Step 5 — Holders

The holders tab shows 1,940 holders. Identifying the pool and burn addresses first, the top ten remaining wallets hold roughly 44% of supply between them. Four of those wallets hold suspiciously similar amounts.

RESULT

CONCERN. A healthy-looking holder count conceals heavy concentration. Clicking into those four wallets shows each was funded by the same address shortly before launch — a cluster, not four independent buyers.

Step 6 — Creator Wallet

The deployer address has created several tokens over the past month. In at least two cases, the wallet sold a large position within hours of launch.

RESULT

CONCERN. A repeated launch-and-sell pattern is one of the strongest warning signs available, and it is public information anyone can check.

Step 7 — Volume Quality

Volume looks healthy at \$340K, but the pair page shows only about 120 unique traders. The transaction feed shows many similar-sized trades cycling between a small set of addresses, and very few successful sells from ordinary wallets.

RESULT

CONCERN. Volume this high from this few traders suggests wash trading. The scarcity of ordinary sells also raises a honeypot question we cannot resolve from the outside.

Step 8 — Community

The X account has 41,000 followers. Recent posts average a handful of replies, most of them one word or a single emoji, from accounts created within the last month. The Telegram group has 12,000 members and almost no conversation that is not a price question. The website states the contract address correctly, but its other pages are largely placeholder text.

RESULT

CONCERN. Follower count is purchasable. What we are looking for — genuine, varied conversation — is absent.

Step 9 — Narrative

\$NOVA's theme closely mirrors a token that trended two days earlier, with a changed name and recoloured logo. No independent community has formed around the idea itself.

RESULT

CONCERN. A derivative narrative with no organic discussion gives no reason to expect sustained interest.

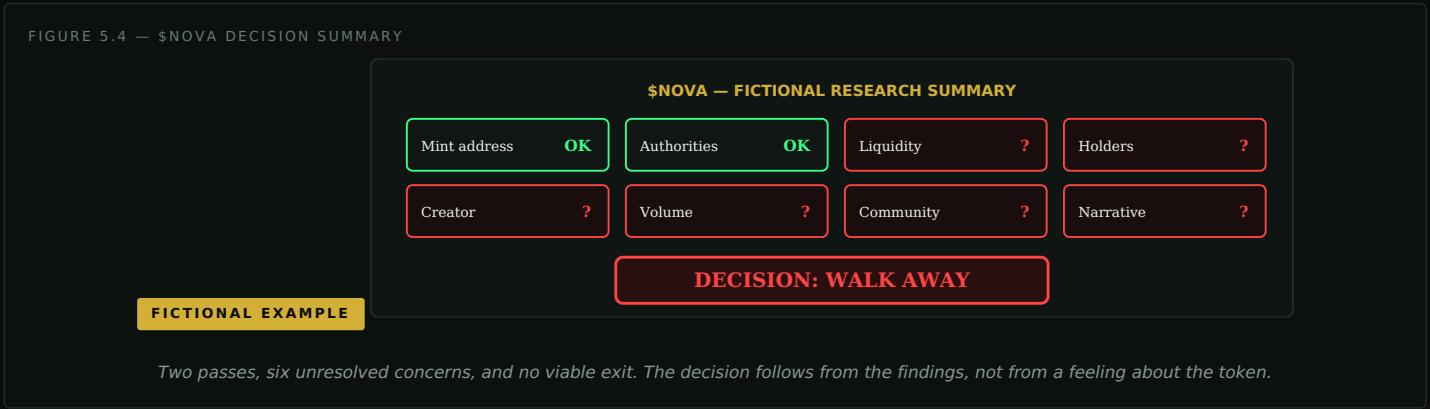
Step 10 — Risk Score: Recording What Is Unresolved

STEP	FINDING	STATUS
2. Mint address	Consistent across three independent sources	Pass
3. Authorities	Mint and freeze both renounced	Pass
4. Liquidity	Thin vs market cap; LP unlocked, single provider	Unresolved
5. Holders	Top 10 hold ~44%; four-wallet cluster, common funder	Unresolved
6. Creator	Repeat launches with fast large sells	Unresolved
7. Volume	High volume, ~120 traders, few ordinary sells	Unresolved
8. Community	Large counts, negligible genuine engagement	Unresolved
9. Narrative	Derivative, no organic discussion	Unresolved

Six unresolved concerns, two of which — the wallet cluster and the creator's history — describe a structure where a small coordinated group holds enough supply to exit through anyone who buys later.

Step 11 — Exit Plan and Decision

Before deciding, we test the exit: with roughly \$61K of liquidity, a position of any meaningful size could not be sold without significant price impact — and that assumes the pool is still there, which unlocked LP tokens do not guarantee.



Decision: Walk Away

\$NOVA passed the two checks most often quoted as proof of safety — renounced mint and freeze authorities — and still failed overall. Nothing about this conclusion predicts what the token's price would do next. It might rise. The point is that we could not verify enough to justify the risk, and that is a sufficient reason on its own.

- WHAT THIS EXAMPLE TEACHES**
- Every concern above was discoverable from free, public tools before buying.
 - Passing early steps does not offset failures in later ones.
 - "Unresolved" is not the same as "fine" — unknown is unknown.
 - A walk-away is a successful research session, not a wasted one.

5.4 When To Stop Researching and Walk Away

Most of your research sessions should end in "no." Clear stopping conditions:

- ☐ You cannot independently verify the mint address from an official source
- ☐ Liquidity is too thin for the position size you had in mind
- ☐ A small number of non-pool wallets control a large share of supply
- ☐ The creator wallet shows a repeated launch-and-dump pattern
- ☐ You can't find genuine community conversation anywhere
- ☐ Something feels off and you can't explain why — that's a valid reason to pass
- ☐ You're feeling rushed by urgency someone else created

There Is Always Another Token

Hundreds of new Solana tokens launch daily. Missing one costs you nothing. Skipping research on one can cost you everything you put in. The asymmetry is not close.

5.5 Chart Reading: Common Patterns Beginners Misread

WHAT YOU SEE	WHAT BEGINNERS ASSUME	WHAT IT MIGHT ALSO BE
Long, smooth rise	Strong demand	A honeypot where nobody can sell
Sudden vertical spike	News or a breakout	A single large buy in a thin pool, or wash trading
Long lower wicks	Buyers stepping in	Thin liquidity causing erratic prints
Flat line after launch	Accumulation	No real trading activity at all
Sharp drop then recovery	Dip to buy	Insider selling absorbed by new buyers

Charts Do Not Replace On-Chain Research

Price action tells you what happened, never why. Every chart interpretation above becomes meaningful only when you combine it with holder, liquidity, and authority data. In thin memecoin markets, charts can be shaped deliberately by a small number of wallets.

5.6 Timeframes

Most charting tools let you switch between timeframes (1 minute, 5 minutes, 1 hour, and so on). Each candle then represents that much time.

- **Very short timeframes (1m-5m)** show noise and are easy to over-interpret, especially on a token only hours old.
- **Medium timeframes (1h-4h)** give a clearer sense of overall direction, when enough history exists.
- **Longer timeframes** often simply don't exist yet for new memecoins, which is itself a useful reminder of how little history you're working with.

5.7 Volatility Expectations

WHY IT MATTERS

Position sizing and exit planning only make sense once you accept how violently these assets move. A drawdown that would be extraordinary in traditional markets is routine here. If a 50% move against you would force a panicked decision, the position was too large for your risk tolerance — that's a sizing problem, not a market problem.

5.8 The Beginner Research Routine

The eleven steps condensed into a repeatable working order you can run from top to bottom on any candidate. Keep this page open beside your browser.

FIGURE 5.5 — THE WORKING ROUTINE



Ten passes over the same token. Anything you cannot verify stays unresolved and carries forward to the decision.

#	DO THIS	WHERE	STOP IF...
1	Find the candidate	DEX Screener, Solana chain	It fails your filter entirely
2	Verify the mint address	Website + pinned post + pair page	Sources disagree or none is official
3	Check mint and freeze authority	Explorer token page	Active with no stated reason
4	Check liquidity depth and LP status	Pair page + explorer	Too thin to exit your intended size
5	Check holder concentration	Explorer holders tab	A few non-pool wallets dominate supply
6	Check the creator wallet	Explorer, deployer address	Repeat launch-and-sell pattern
7	Check volume quality	Pair page + transaction feed	Volume high, unique traders low
8	Check the community	X, Telegram, Discord, website	Counts are large, conversation is absent
9	Check the narrative	Community discussion itself	It exists only in paid promotion
10	Record risk, plan the exit, decide	Your research sheet	You cannot explain why you would buy

Read This Before Using The Routine

This is a workflow, not a guarantee. Working through all ten passes does not make a token safe and does not protect you from loss. If something cannot be verified, treat it as unresolved — never as acceptable.

On Speed

This guide deliberately gives no target time for completing the routine. Some tokens are eliminated in under a minute at step two; others need far longer, and some questions never resolve at all. If you find yourself rushing the routine because a price is moving, that is precisely the moment the routine exists to protect you from.

Part 05 Recap

01 02 03 04 05 06 07 08 09 10

WHAT YOU SHOULD NOW BE ABLE TO DO

- ☐ Run every candidate through all 11 steps — in order, every time
- ☐ Most research sessions should correctly end in "no"
- ☐ A risk score organizes findings; it does not predict outcomes
- ☐ Charts describe what happened; on-chain data explains the context
- ☐ Renounced authorities alone never make a token safe
- ☐ Expect extreme volatility and size positions accordingly

NEXT > PART 06 — BUYING & EXECUTION

BUYING & EXECUTION

Once research is complete, this part covers the mechanics of actually placing a trade on a Solana DEX — and the slippage, price impact, and wallet-signature risks that trip up beginners at the exact moment they're excited to buy.

6.1 Before You Buy: The Checklist

- ☐ Correct mint address confirmed from an independent source
- ☐ Correct network confirmed (Solana)
- ☐ Liquidity checked and adequate for your position size
- ☐ Holder distribution checked
- ☐ Community checked
- ☐ Contract / token authorities checked
- ☐ Volume checked and looks organic
- ☐ Exit route understood before entering
- ☐ Position size decided in advance

If Any Box Is Unchecked

Don't buy yet. The checklist exists precisely for the moment excitement is highest and discipline is lowest.

6.2 Swapping on a Solana DEX

WHAT IT IS

A decentralized exchange (DEX) lets you swap one token for another directly from your wallet, without a middleman holding your funds. On Solana, this is how virtually all memecoin buying and selling happens. Use a well-established, reputable Solana DEX or aggregator — avoid unfamiliar or unverified swap sites, which are a common vector for theft.

1. Open the DEX and connect your wallet.
2. Select the token you're selling (typically SOL) and the token you're receiving (the memecoin), using the verified mint address.
3. Enter the amount you intend to spend.
4. Review the quote: expected tokens received, slippage tolerance, minimum received, price impact, and the network fee.
5. Confirm in the app, then approve the signature request in your wallet.
6. Wait for on-chain confirmation, then verify the new token balance in your wallet.

FIGURE 6.1 — MOCK DEX SWAP SCREEN

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE

SWAP

You Pay: 1.0 SOL

You Receive: ~100,000 \$TOKEN

Slippage: 1.0%

Price Impact: 0.4%

Network Fee: ~\$0.001

Minimum Received: 99,000 \$TOKEN

CONFIRM SWAP

The core swap fields: token in, token out, slippage, minimum received, price impact, and network fee.

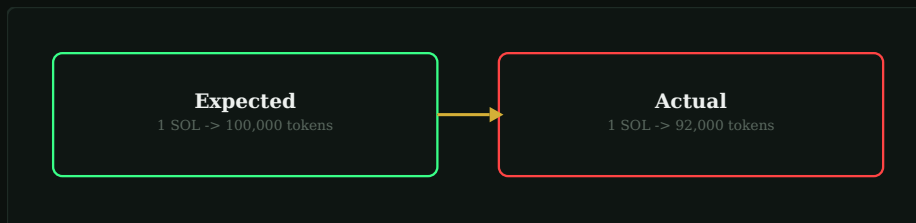
6.3 Slippage & Price Impact

WHAT IT IS

Price impact is how much your own trade moves the price, caused by the size of your order relative to available liquidity.

Slippage tolerance is the maximum difference between the quoted price and the executed price that you're willing to accept — if the price moves more than that before your trade confirms, the transaction fails rather than executing at a worse price.

FIGURE 6.2 — SLIPPAGE EXAMPLE



Expected: 1 SOL for 100,000 tokens. Actual received: 92,000 tokens — the difference between the quote and the executed trade, caused by price movement and pool depth between quote and confirmation.

Common Mistake

Never blindly increase your slippage tolerance just because a trade keeps failing. A failing trade on a very low-liquidity or highly volatile token is often the market telling you the trade is riskier than it looks — not a technical glitch to brute-force past. Extremely high slippage settings can also make you vulnerable to certain manipulation tactics on illiquid tokens.

Before-You-Confirm Checklist

- ☐ Does the minimum received amount look reasonable for the price impact shown?
- ☐ Is the network fee normal, or unexpectedly high?
- ☐ Is your slippage tolerance set deliberately, not left on a default you haven't checked?
- ☐ Are you buying the exact mint address you verified earlier?

6.4 Wallet Security While Trading

CORE RULES

- Never share your recovery phrase or private key — ever, with anyone, for any reason.
- Never connect your wallet to a link from an unsolicited message, comment, or ad.
- Always verify a site's URL character-by-character before connecting.
- Ignore "claim your airdrop" prompts you didn't seek out yourself.
- No real support agent will ever DM you first or ask for your recovery phrase.
- Read every wallet signature request — understand what you're approving before you approve it.
- Consider a separate, lower-balance "trading wallet" isolated from your main holdings.
- Consider a hardware wallet for balances you'd be very upset to lose.

Signature Request (SAFE)

site you intended, clear permission

Signature Request (DANGEROUS)

unexpected, unclear, broad access

A signature request you understand, from a site you intended to visit, is normal. An unexpected, unclear, or unusually broad permission request is a reason to stop and investigate before approving.

6.5 Choosing Where To Swap

WHAT IT IS

On Solana you'll encounter both individual DEXs and **aggregators**, which route your trade across multiple DEXs to find a better overall rate. For beginners, a well-established aggregator or major DEX is usually the simpler choice.

AVOID

- Swap sites you found only through a DM, reply, or advertisement
- Sites with URLs that closely imitate a well-known DEX's name
- Any site that asks for your recovery phrase or private key at any point
- Sites requesting broad token permissions for a simple swap

Habit

Bookmark the DEX you use and always navigate from your own bookmark rather than from search results or links. This single habit defeats most fake-site attacks.

6.6 When a Transaction Fails

Failed transactions are common on Solana during volatile periods. A failure is usually not a sign something is broken.

CAUSE	WHAT IT MEANS	REASONABLE RESPONSE
Slippage exceeded	Price moved beyond your tolerance before confirmation	Reassess — don't reflexively raise tolerance
Network congestion	Transaction wasn't processed in time	Wait and retry
Insufficient SOL	Not enough SOL for fees or token account rent	Top up your SOL cushion
Route unavailable	Liquidity shifted mid-quote	Refresh the quote
Repeated failures on one token	Possible sell restriction or extreme illiquidity	Investigate before trying again

Note On Failed Transactions

A failed transaction can still consume a small network fee, because the network did work attempting it. This is normal and is not a sign you were scammed.

6.7 Position Sizing

WHY IT MATTERS

Position size is the single variable you fully control. Research reduces the chance of buying an outright scam; position size determines what happens to you when a legitimate, well-researched position simply doesn't work out — which will happen.

- Decide the amount before you look at the chart, not after.
- Size so that a total loss of that position is genuinely survivable and doesn't change your financial situation.

- Never size a position based on how confident a promoter sounds.
- Consider the liquidity: if exiting your intended position size would cause severe price impact, the position is too large for that token regardless of your risk tolerance.

No Recommended Numbers

This guide deliberately does not suggest a percentage of your portfolio to allocate. Appropriate sizing depends entirely on your personal financial situation, and for many people the appropriate allocation to this asset class is zero.

6.8 Jupiter — Solana Swap Aggregator

WHAT IT IS

Jupiter is a commonly used Solana swap aggregator. A **swap aggregator** does not hold its own liquidity. Instead, it searches across many Solana DEXs and liquidity pools, then builds a route for your trade — sometimes splitting one swap across several pools to get a better overall rate than any single venue would give.

WHY ROUTING CAN MATTER

On a thinly traded memecoin, the same order can produce noticeably different results depending on which pool it goes through. An aggregator's routing is an attempt to reduce that difference. It does not eliminate price impact, and it cannot create liquidity that does not exist.

How a Quote Works

When you enter an amount, the aggregator returns a **quote**: the route it found, the estimated amount you would receive, the price impact, and your minimum received at the current slippage setting. A quote is an estimate at that instant — prices move between quoting and confirming, which is exactly what slippage tolerance accounts for.

FIGURE 6.4 — MOCK AGGREGATOR SWAP INTERFACE

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE — NOT LIVE PRICING

SWAP AGGREGATOR

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE

YOU PAY: 1.00 SOL

↓

YOU RECEIVE: ~ 100,000 \$TOKEN

ROUTE: SOL → Pool A (60%) + Pool B (40%) → \$TOKEN

Price Impact: 0.9%

Slippage: 1.0%

Network Fee: ~\$0.001

MINIMUM RECEIVED: 99,000 \$TOKEN

Figures invented for teaching — not live pricing

A generic aggregator layout. Figures shown are invented for teaching and do not reflect any real token, route, or market price.

The Four Fields To Read Every Time

FIELD	WHAT IT MEANS	WHAT TO CHECK
Route	Which pools the trade passes through	That a route exists at all — no route means no liquidity
Price impact	How much your own order moves the price	Whether it is acceptable for your size, in both directions
Minimum received	The worst outcome you have agreed to accept	That the gap from the quote is one you are willing to take
Slippage tolerance	How far the price may move before the trade fails	That you set it deliberately, not left it on a default

Verify the Mint Before You Swap

WHAT TO DO

Search by the exact mint address you verified in step two of the research routine — never by ticker or name. Aggregators list every token that exists on Solana, including copies of popular ones. Once the token is selected, confirm the address shown in the interface matches your verified address character-for-character before entering an amount.

Checking the Wallet Request

After you confirm on the site, your wallet opens a separate request. This is the last point at which you control the outcome.

- ☐ The token being sent, and the amount, match what you entered
- ☐ The token being received is the mint address you verified
- ☐ The request is a swap, not a broad approval or delegation
- ☐ Your wallet shows no security warning on the site or the transaction
- ☐ The estimated network fee looks ordinary

Never Approve Blindly

Signing is irreversible. If a request does not match what you expected, or you cannot tell what it does, reject it and investigate. A rejected transaction costs you nothing; an approved malicious one can cost you everything in the wallet.

6.9 Fast-Execution Trading Terminals (Axiom and Similar)

WHAT IT IS

Axiom is a web-based Solana trading terminal — you trade directly in a browser rather than through a wallet app and a separate DEX site. It bundles charting, token screening, wallet tracking, and one-click buy/sell into a single interface built for speed. Photon and similar web terminals work the same way; Telegram-based bots such as BullX or Maestro follow the same underlying idea through a chat interface instead of a browser.

This Does Not Replace The Research System

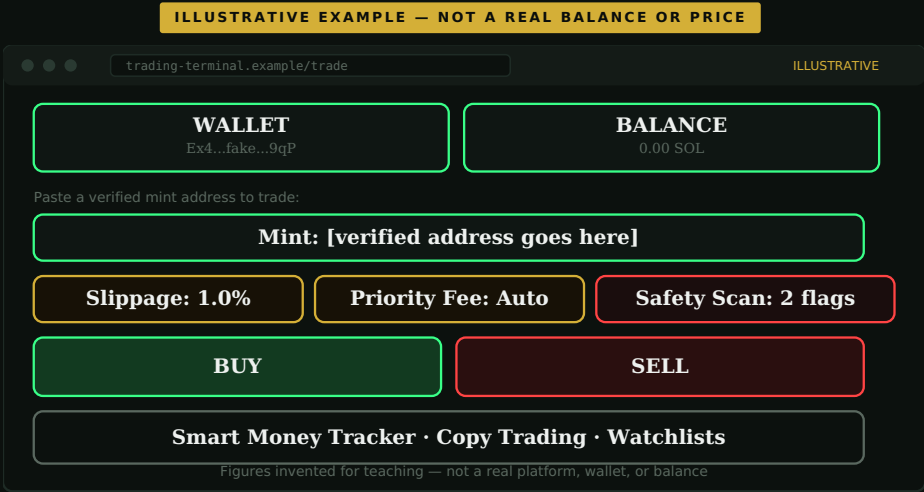
These platforms are built for speed — fast entries, instant-buy tools on new launches, one-click execution. Speed is the opposite of what Parts 04 and 05 are asking you to do. If you use a tool like this at all, use it only after a token has already cleared your normal research process — never as a shortcut to buy something faster than you could otherwise check it.

Setting It Up

1. Reach the platform only through its official website, at a URL you have independently verified and reached by your own bookmark — never a link from a reply, DM, ad, or search result.
2. There is no official Telegram bot for this platform — it operates as a website only. Any Telegram bot claiming to be it is impersonation, and the same rule from Section 4.11 applies: treat it as an attempt to steal whatever you send it.
3. Create an account and either connect an existing self-custody wallet or let the platform generate a new embedded wallet for you. If it generates one, it will show you the address.
4. Treat this exactly like the trading wallet described in Section 1.10: a small, isolated balance, separate from your main holdings, sized for what you're willing to risk on a connection to something you interact with often.

Funding It

Copy the wallet address the platform shows you and send SOL to it from your own self-custody wallet or an exchange withdrawal — the same process as Part 02, including a small test transfer first and confirming arrival before sending the remainder.



A generic browser-based trading terminal layout. Wallet balance, token list, and buttons are invented for teaching.

Buying and Selling

- ☐ Paste the exact, independently verified mint address — the same rule as Section 6.8. These platforms also let you search by ticker or name; using that instead of the mint address defeats the verification step, so avoid it.
- ☐ Enter the amount and confirm. The platform routes the trade on-chain, typically through the same DEXs and aggregators covered elsewhere in this guide.
- ☐ Selling works the same way in reverse: open the position, choose an amount or percentage, confirm.

Features Worth Understanding Before You Touch Them

FEATURE	WHAT IT DOES	WHAT TO WATCH FOR
Smart Money / wallet tracking	Flags activity from wallets the platform tags as notable	A tag is not verification — run the wallet through your own checks
Automated / copy trading	Mirrors another wallet's trades automatically	You are outsourcing the entire research process to that wallet's owner, unknowns included
Built-in token safety scans	Surfaces authority status, LP status, and similar flags inline	Same rule as Section 4.14 — one input, never a verdict
Slippage & priority fee controls	Sets execution tolerance and transaction priority	Same rule as Section 6.3 — don't loosen these just to force a trade through
Instant-buy / sniper tools	Buys the instant a token becomes tradable	By definition, none of the checks in Part 04 are possible yet

Exporting the Wallet

Most of these platforms let you export the private key for the wallet they generated, usually from a wallet or settings menu. This key is subject to every rule in Section 1.11: never share it, never paste it into a website, and store any written copy the same way you would a recovery phrase.

Adding It to Phantom as a Second Wallet

WHAT TO DO

1. In Phantom, open the account switcher and choose the option to add an account by importing a private key.
2. Paste the exported private key directly into Phantom's import screen — nowhere else.
3. The platform's wallet now appears as a second account inside Phantom, letting you monitor it alongside your main holdings using the same explorer habits from Part 01.

Why Do This

Consolidating visibility into one wallet app makes the monitoring routine in Section 7.1 easier to actually follow. It does not change who controls the funds — both wallets remain self-custodial, and whoever holds either private key controls that wallet completely.

The Trade-Off, Plainly

A browser-based embedded wallet is still a hot wallet, tied to that platform's own infrastructure. That is a different, and in some ways larger, attack surface than signing your own transactions in a wallet you control end to end — a compromised site or a convincing phishing clone can put funds at risk in ways a standalone wallet app is not exposed to. The speed these tools offer is real. So is the reason this guide's core method — verify, then swap through a DEX or aggregator yourself — puts research before execution rather than after it.

Part 06 Recap

- 01
- 02
- 03
- 04
- 05
- 06
- 07
- 08
- 09
- 10

WHAT YOU SHOULD NOW BE ABLE TO DO

- ☐

Complete the pre-buy checklist before opening the swap screen
- ☐

Read every signature request; reject anything unexpected or unclear
- ☐

Use a bookmarked, reputable DEX or aggregator
- ☐

Decide position size in advance, sized against liquidity and total-loss tolerance
- ☐

Review slippage, price impact, minimum received, and fee before confirming
- ☐

Trading bots trade speed for research time — verify before you use one, not after
- ☐

Never raise slippage just to force a failing trade through
- ☐

An exported private key follows the same rules as a recovery phrase

MONITORING & EXITING

Buying is the easy part. This part covers watching a position after you've bought, building an exit plan before you need one, and the mechanics of actually selling.

7.1 Monitoring a Position

After buying, periodically revisit the same signals you checked before buying — conditions change quickly in this space.

- Liquidity trend — is it stable, growing, or quietly shrinking?
- Holder concentration — has a new wallet accumulated a large share?
- Volume — is trading still active, or has it gone quiet?
- Community — is the project's team and community still active and consistent?
- Authorities — has anything about mint/freeze status changed?

Practical Habit

Check your open positions on a schedule that matches how actively you're trading — daily at minimum for an active memecoin position — rather than only when price moves sharply, since some of the most important warning signs (liquidity draining, authority changes) don't always show up as a price move yet.

7.2 Building an Exit Plan Before You Buy

Why Before, Not After

Once you're holding a position and the price is moving, emotion makes decisions worse. Deciding your exit conditions in advance — while you're calm — is one of the highest-value habits in this entire guide.

Exit Plan Components (Frameworks, Not Guarantees)

CONCEPT	WHAT IT MEANS
Profit-taking	Selling some or all of a position after gains, on rules you set in advance
Partial exits	Selling a portion at set milestones rather than all-or-nothing
Invalidation	The specific condition that would prove your original thesis wrong

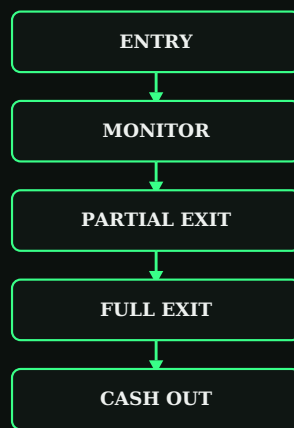
Signals that commonly justify exiting, regardless of price:

- Liquidity deteriorating
- Narrative failing to hold up under continued scrutiny
- Team or community behavior changing for the worse
- Sudden, unexplained holder concentration
- A contract authority change you didn't expect
- Major, sustained sell pressure with no clear cause

No Guaranteed Targets

This guide will not give you a specific profit percentage or price target that is guaranteed to work. Any numbers you use are a personal framework you set based on your own risk tolerance — not a formula that predicts outcomes.

FIGURE 7.1



Entry is only step one. Monitoring, partial exits, full exit, and cashing out are all part of the same plan — ideally decided before you buy.

7.3 Selling a Solana Memecoin

1. Open your DEX.
2. Connect your wallet if not already connected.
3. Select the token you're selling.
4. Select SOL or a stablecoin as the output asset.
5. Enter the amount you want to sell.
6. Review the price impact.
7. Review the slippage tolerance.
8. Review the minimum amount you'll receive.
9. Confirm the swap and approve the signature in your wallet.
10. Verify the transaction on an explorer once it confirms.

FIGURE 7.2 — MOCK SELL SCREEN

ILLUSTRATIVE EXAMPLE

SELL

You Pay: 100,000 \$TOKEN

You Receive: ~0.94 SOL

Slippage: 1.0%

Price Impact: 1.8%

Network Fee: ~\$0.001

Minimum Received: 0.93 SOL

CONFIRM SELL

Selling uses the identical interface as buying, with the token and SOL positions reversed.

Low-Liquidity Selling

If liquidity has thinned since you bought, selling your full position at once may create significant price impact. In that situation, selling in smaller portions can sometimes reduce the impact — though it isn't always possible to exit a low-liquidity position without a meaningful loss. This is exactly why liquidity was checked before buying.

7.4 A Practical Monitoring Routine

Rather than staring at the chart, run a short structured check on a schedule.

CHECK	WHERE	WARNING SIGN
Liquidity depth	DEX Screener / pair page	Declining steadily over days
Top holder changes	Explorer holders tab	A new wallet accumulating a large share
Creator wallet activity	Explorer, creator address	Large outbound transfers or sells
Unique traders	Pair page	Volume holding up while trader count collapses
Authorities	Explorer token page	Any change from what you recorded before buying
Community	X / Telegram	Team gone quiet, moderators leaving, questions being deleted

Write It Down

Record the key numbers at the moment you buy — liquidity, top-10 concentration, holder count. Monitoring is much more useful when you have a baseline to compare against rather than a vague memory.

7.5 Exit Frameworks (Examples Only)

Frameworks, Not Recommendations

The structures below are ways people organize exit decisions. They are not strategies this guide endorses, and none of them improves your odds or protects you from loss. Choose or build your own approach based on your own risk tolerance.

FRAMEWORK	STRUCTURE	TRADE-OFF
Staged partial exits	Sell predetermined portions at milestones you set in advance	Reduces exposure gradually; you sell some of any continued rise
Recover-cost approach	Sell a portion sized to return your original outlay, hold the rest	Simple to follow; the remaining position can still go to zero
Thesis-based exit	Exit when your original reason for buying stops being true	Requires writing the thesis down beforehand and being honest later
Time-based review	Re-evaluate at fixed intervals regardless of price	Counteracts drifting; may exit before a move you expected

7.6 Exiting Under Pressure

SITUATIONS THAT FORCE FAST DECISIONS

- **Liquidity suddenly removed.** There may be no meaningful exit left. This is why liquidity lock status was checked before buying.
- **A large holder begins selling.** Price impact can be severe and immediate.
- **The team disappears.** Socials deleted, site offline, moderators gone.
- **An authority change appears.** Treat as a serious warning regardless of price.

WHAT TO DO

Decide in advance, calmly, which of these conditions would cause you to exit immediately regardless of whether you're up or down. Writing them down before you buy is what makes it possible to act on them later without freezing.

Part 07 Recap

01 02 03 04 05 06 07 08 09 10

WHAT YOU SHOULD NOW BE ABLE TO DO

- ☐ Record baseline metrics at the moment you buy
- ☐ Exit frameworks are personal structures, never guarantees
- ☐ Monitor liquidity, holders, authorities, and community — not only price
- ☐ Selling uses the same mechanics as buying; always review price impact
- ☐ Write your exit conditions down before entering
- ☐ Some exit conditions are non-negotiable and should trigger regardless of profit or loss

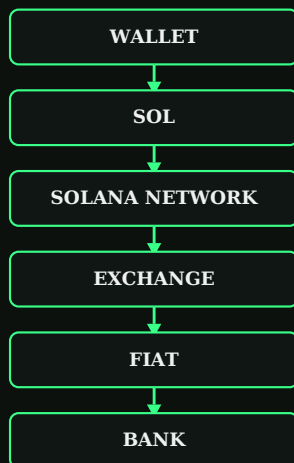
NEXT > PART 08 — CASHING OUT

CASHING OUT

This part closes the loop: moving SOL from your self-custody wallet back to an exchange, converting it to fiat currency, and getting it into your bank account — plus the record-keeping habits that make tax time far less painful.

8.1 Moving SOL Back to an Exchange

FIGURE 8.1



The reverse of Part 02's funding path: wallet to exchange, exchange to fiat, fiat to bank.

1. Open your chosen exchange and go to its **Deposit** section.
2. Select SOL (or whichever supported asset you're moving) and confirm the exchange's current deposit address and required network.
3. Copy that deposit address into your wallet's send screen.
4. Send a small test transfer first.
5. Confirm the test arrived and credited correctly on the exchange.
6. Send the remainder.

BEFORE EVERY TRANSFER

Always open the exchange's current deposit page directly and re-confirm the address and supported network — deposit addresses and supported networks can change, and using an old or copied address is a common way funds are lost.

8.2 Cashing Out to Fiat

1. Sell SOL (or your other supported asset) for your local fiat currency, or for a stablecoin first if that's your exchange's normal flow.
2. Confirm the fiat balance appears in your exchange account.
3. Initiate a withdrawal to your linked bank account.
4. Allow for standard payment processing time — this varies by exchange, country, and payment method, from same-day to several business days.
5. Review any withdrawal fees before confirming.

Note

Exact fiat withdrawal options, processing times, and any additional verification steps depend on your country and your specific exchange. Check your exchange's current documentation for your region.

8.3 Tax & Record Keeping

Rules Differ By Country

Cryptocurrency tax treatment varies significantly by jurisdiction and changes over time. This guide cannot tell you what you owe. Consult a qualified local tax professional for guidance specific to your situation.

Records Worth Keeping For Every Trade

- ☐ Date and time of each buy and sell
- ☐ Amount and asset bought or sold
- ☐ Fiat value at the time of the transaction
- ☐ Fees paid, both exchange and network fees
- ☐ Wallet-to-wallet transfers, including internal transfers between your own wallets
- ☐ Transaction signatures / hashes for each on-chain transaction

HOW TO MAKE THIS EASY

Keep a simple running spreadsheet as you trade, rather than trying to reconstruct everything later from memory or scattered screenshots. Many exchanges also offer downloadable transaction history exports — save these periodically.

8.4 Building a Transaction Log

A simple spreadsheet, updated as you trade, covers nearly everything you'll need later.

COLUMN	EXAMPLE ENTRY
Date & time	2026-03-14 19:42 UTC
Action	Buy / Sell / Transfer in / Transfer out
Asset	SOL, or token ticker + mint address
Amount	Quantity of the asset
Price / rate	Rate at the time of the transaction
Fiat value at the time	Value in your local currency at that moment
Fees	Exchange fee + network fee
Transaction signature	The on-chain identifier
Venue	Exchange name or DEX used
Notes	Anything you'll want context on later

Why This Matters More Than It Sounds

Reconstructing months of memecoin activity after the fact is genuinely difficult — tokens get delisted, prices at the time are hard to recover, and wallet histories get long. Ten seconds per trade now saves many hours later.

8.5 Common Cash-Out Friction

ISSUE	WHY IT HAPPENS	WHAT HELPS
Deposit not credited	Wrong network, or exchange requires more confirmations	Check the transaction on an explorer; contact support through official channels only
Withdrawal limits	Verification tier restrictions	Complete additional verification in advance if you anticipate larger withdrawals
Additional source-of-funds questions	Standard compliance procedure at many exchanges	Your transaction log makes this straightforward to answer
Bank delays	Standard payment processing times	Plan around it; don't assume same-day access
Token not supported for deposit	Exchange only accepts certain assets	Swap to SOL or a supported stablecoin before transferring

Support Channel Warning

If you post about a withdrawal problem publicly, expect fake "support" accounts to contact you within minutes. Only ever use the support channel you reach from inside your logged-in exchange account or from the exchange's official website. No legitimate support will ever ask for your recovery phrase or ask you to connect your wallet to a site.

Part 08 Recap

- 01
- 02
- 03
- 04
- 05
- 06
- 07
- 08
- 09
- 10

WHAT YOU SHOULD NOW BE ABLE TO DO

- ☐

Always open the exchange's current deposit page and confirm the network before sending
- ☐

Expect processing time and check withdrawal fees in advance
- ☐

Test transfer first, every time, in both directions
- ☐

Keep a running transaction log rather than reconstructing later
- ☐

Sell to fiat, confirm the balance, then withdraw to your bank
- ☐

Consult a qualified local tax professional about your obligations

NEXT > PART 09 — RISK MANAGEMENT

RISK MANAGEMENT

Every tool and checklist in this guide sits inside one larger idea: Solana memecoins are extremely speculative, and managing that risk deliberately matters more than any single research trick.

9.1 What "Extremely Speculative" Actually Means

Read This Section Fully

Solana memecoins can lose most or all of their value, in some cases within minutes, even after passing every check in this guide. No amount of research eliminates risk — it only helps you make better-informed decisions and avoid clearly identifiable scams. This guide is educational content, not financial advice, and nothing in it should be read as a promise or prediction of any return.

9.2 Practical Risk Management Habits

- ☐ Only allocate money you can genuinely afford to lose entirely
- ☐ Decide position size before you feel excited about a specific token, not after
- ☐ Treat every "guaranteed" or "can't lose" claim as an automatic red flag
- ☐ Diversify research effort — don't skip steps because a token "feels" safe
- ☐ Separate a small trading wallet from long-term holdings where appropriate
- ☐ Revisit your own exit plan honestly, rather than moving the goalposts under pressure
- ☐ Keep records as you go, not only when tax season arrives
- ☐ Accept that some researched, careful decisions will still lose money — that is the nature of a speculative asset class, not a sign your process failed

9.3 Recognizing Your Own Behavioral Risk

WATCH FOR THESE IN YOURSELF

- Chasing a token because it already went up a lot ("fear of missing out")
- Increasing slippage or position size to force a trade through
- Ignoring a red flag because you already bought and don't want to be wrong
- Trading larger amounts to try to recover a previous loss quickly
- Skipping your own checklist when you're in a hurry or emotionally invested

The research system in this guide only works if you actually follow it when it's inconvenient — which is usually exactly when it matters most.

9.4 Scams That Target You, Not the Token

Much of Part 04 was about evaluating tokens. Equally important is recognizing attacks aimed directly at you as a trader.

ATTACK	HOW IT REACHES YOU	DEFENSE
Wallet-drainer site	A link promising an airdrop, presale, or claim	Only visit bookmarked sites; reject unexpected signature requests
Fake support DM	Reply or DM after you post a problem publicly	Never respond; use official support only
Recovery phrase phishing	A "wallet sync," "validation," or "migration" prompt	Never type your phrase anywhere except your own wallet app
Clipboard malware	Silently swaps a copied address	Verify first and last characters after every paste
Fake token in your wallet	Unsolicited airdrop with a link in its name	Ignore it entirely; don't interact or try to sell it
Group "call" schemes	Coordinated buy signal to a large audience	Treat any recommendation as a candidate to research, never a decision

The One Rule That Prevents Most Losses
Nobody legitimate will ever need your recovery phrase or private key. Not a wallet developer, not an exchange, not a project team, not a support agent, not a moderator, not any AI assistant. There is no exception to this rule and no circumstance that creates one.

9.5 A Realistic Picture of Outcomes

It's worth being direct about what this asset class looks like statistically, because promotional content almost never is.

- A very large share of memecoins launched on Solana lose essentially all value, often within days or hours.
- Many that survive still trade far below their peak attention period.
- Insiders, snipers, and automated traders frequently hold structural advantages in timing and information over an individual researching manually.
- Screenshots of large gains circulate widely; the far more common outcomes do not.

WHY THIS SECTION EXISTS
Knowing this does not mean you can't participate thoughtfully. It means you should participate with money you can afford to lose entirely, with a research process, and without expectations shaped by the most visible and least representative results you see online.

Part 09 Recap

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WHAT YOU SHOULD NOW BE ABLE TO DO

- ☐ Only allocate money whose total loss would not affect your financial wellbeing
- ☐ Watch your own behavior as carefully as you watch the market
- ☐ Research reduces avoidable losses; it never eliminates risk
- ☐ Treat any guaranteed-return claim as automatic disqualification
- ☐ Most scam losses come from signatures and phishing, not from bad token picks
- ☐ Your recovery phrase is never shared with anyone, ever, under any circumstances

NEXT > PART 10 — CHECKLISTS & TOOLS

CHECKLISTS & TOOLS

A printable master checklist, a one-page DEX Screener quick reference, and a full glossary of every term used in this guide — for fast lookup after you've read the rest.

10.1 Pre-Buy Checklist

Work top to bottom. A blank box is an unresolved item, and unresolved items carry forward into the decision at the bottom of the page.

Identity

- ☐ Mint address verified
- ☐ Official sources cross-checked (website, pinned post, pair page)

Security & Ownership

- ☐ Mint authority checked
- ☐ Freeze authority checked
- ☐ Holder concentration checked (top 10, excluding pool and burn)
- ☐ Creator / deployer wallet checked
- ☐ Wallet clusters checked (common funding source)

Market Structure

- ☐ Liquidity checked against your intended position size
- ☐ LP status checked (locked, burned, or removable)
- ☐ Volume quality checked against unique traders
- ☐ Successful sells from ordinary wallets observed

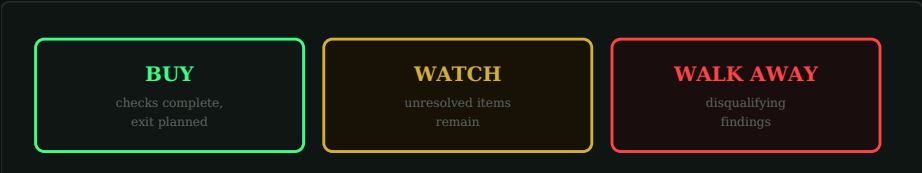
Context

- ☐ Community checked for genuine engagement
- ☐ Website checked
- ☐ Narrative understood

Decision Inputs

- ☐ Risk documented, including everything still unresolved
- ☐ Exit plan created before entering

FIGURE 10.1 — THE THREE OUTCOMES



Every completed checklist ends in one of three decisions. Two of them involve not buying, and both are legitimate results.

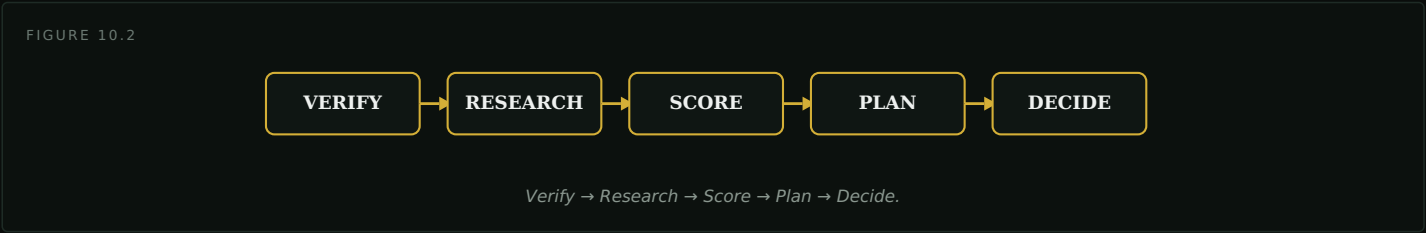
Decision

- ☐ **BUY** — checks complete, risks understood and accepted, exit planned
- ☐ **WATCH** — promising but unresolved items remain; revisit later
- ☐ **WALK AWAY** — unresolved or disqualifying findings

10.2 DEX Screener Quick Reference

CHAIN
Solana

PRESET	MARKET CAP	24H VOLUME	LIQUIDITY
Early Discovery	\$40K-\$5M	\$100K+	\$30K+
More Established	\$250K-\$10M	\$250K+	\$75K+
Very Early / High Risk	\$40K-\$1M	\$25K+	\$15K+



Remember
Filters find candidates. They do not find guaranteed winners.

10.3 Checklist — While Holding

- ☐ Baseline metrics recorded at time of purchase
- ☐ Liquidity re-checked and stable or growing
- ☐ Top holder list re-checked for new concentration
- ☐ Creator wallet re-checked for large outbound activity
- ☐ Unique trader count still healthy relative to volume
- ☐ Token authorities unchanged since purchase
- ☐ Community and team still active and consistent
- ☐ Exit conditions still written down and unchanged by emotion

10.4 Checklist — Before Selling

- ☐ Correct token selected in the swap interface
- ☐ Output asset set to SOL or a supported stablecoin
- ☐ Price impact reviewed for your full sell size
- ☐ Slippage tolerance set deliberately
- ☐ Minimum received amount reviewed and acceptable
- ☐ Considered splitting the sell if liquidity is thin
- ☐ Transaction verified on an explorer after confirming
- ☐ Trade recorded in your transaction log

10.5 Checklist — Cashing Out

- ☐ Exchange deposit page opened directly and network confirmed
- ☐ Deposit address copied fresh (never reused from an old note)
- ☐ First and last characters verified after pasting
- ☐ Small test transfer sent and credited successfully
- ☐ Remainder sent only after the test confirmed
- ☐ Sold to fiat and fiat balance confirmed on the exchange
- ☐ Withdrawal fee and processing time reviewed
- ☐ All transactions, fees, and signatures added to your log

10.6 Security Checklist — Review Monthly

- ☐ Recovery phrase stored offline, never digitally, never shared
- ☐ Wallet app downloaded only from official sources
- ☐ Connected sites reviewed and unused ones disconnected
- ☐ Old token approvals and delegations reviewed and revoked
- ☐ Trading wallet balance kept separate from main holdings
- ☐ Hardware wallet considered for larger balances
- ☐ Bookmarks used for all DEX and exchange access
- ☐ Unsolicited airdropped tokens ignored, never interacted with

10.7 Tool Categories Reference

Rather than a list of links that will age, here's what each category of tool is for and what to use it for during research.

CATEGORY	EXAMPLES	WHAT YOU USE IT FOR
Block explorer	Solscan, Solana Explorer	Mint address, supply, authorities, holders, transactions
Pair / chart aggregator	DEX Screener	Discovery filters, liquidity, volume, traders, pair age
Self-custody wallet	Phantom, Solflare, Backpack	Holding, signing, swapping, connecting to apps
Hardware wallet	Ledger and similar	Offline key storage for larger balances
DEX / aggregator	Established Solana swap venues	Executing buys and sells
Launchpad	Pump.fun	Observing earliest-stage launches (research source, not a buy signal)
Centralized exchange	Coinbase, Kraken, Binance, Bybit, others	Buying SOL with fiat; cashing out to a bank
Record keeping	A spreadsheet	Transaction log for tax and review purposes

Always Verify Current URLs

Phishing sites imitating every tool above exist. Reach each one through a bookmark you created after verifying the site, not through search results, ads, or links in messages.

10.8 Frequently Asked Questions

Do I need a lot of SOL to start?

No — but you do need enough to cover network fees and token account rent beyond whatever you're trading, and enough that exchange withdrawal fees aren't a large proportion of the amount. Only use money you can afford to lose entirely.

Can I trade memecoins directly on an exchange?

Generally no. Most new memecoins are never listed on centralized exchanges. That's why the self-custody wallet and DEX workflow in this guide exists.

A token appeared in my wallet that I didn't buy. What do I do?

Ignore it. Unsolicited airdrops are frequently bait designed to get you to visit a site and approve a malicious signature. Don't interact with it and don't try to sell it.

Is a renounced mint authority enough to call a token safe?

No. It removes one specific risk. Holder concentration, liquidity removal, honeypot mechanics, and simple abandonment all remain possible. Safety is never established by a single check.

Someone in a group posted a contract address. Should I use it?

Not directly. Verify that exact mint address against the project's official website and pinned announcement before doing anything with it. Posting fake contract addresses in replies is one of the most common attacks in this space.

My transaction failed. Was I scammed?

Usually not — failures from slippage or congestion are routine, and a small fee may still be consumed. But repeated failures selling one specific token warrant investigation before you try again.

How much should I invest?

This guide can't answer that, and anyone who answers it confidently without knowing your finances is not giving you advice worth taking. For many people the appropriate amount in this asset class is zero. Speak with a qualified financial professional about your own situation.

10.9 Official Solana Resources

Commonly used tools in the Solana ecosystem, grouped by what they are for. None of these is endorsed as the safest or best option — they are examples of established, widely used services. Always confirm you are on the correct site.

Wallets — hold your keys and sign transactions

SERVICE	ADDRESS	NOTE
Phantom	phantom.com	Beginner-friendly example used throughout this guide
Solflare	solflare.com	Commonly used Solana wallet
Backpack	backpack.app	Commonly used Solana wallet

Explorers — verify mints, authorities, holders, transactions

SERVICE	ADDRESS	NOTE
Solscan	solscan.io	Commonly used block explorer
Solana Explorer	explorer.solana.com	The network's own explorer

Discovery — find and filter candidates

SERVICE	ADDRESS	NOTE
DEX Screener	dexscreener.com	Example discovery and charting tool; listing is not vetting

Swaps — execute buys and sells

SERVICE	ADDRESS	NOTE
Jupiter	jup.ag	Example Solana swap aggregator (see Section 6.8)
Other established Solana DEXs and aggregators	—	Several exist; prefer well-established venues you reached by bookmark

Trading bots — optional, advanced, speed-oriented (see Section 6.9)

SERVICE	ADDRESS	NOTE
Axiom	axiom.trade	Example web-based trading terminal; built for speed, not research
Other Telegram/web trading bots	—	Several exist; the same verification and custody rules apply to all of them

Launchpad — where many new tokens originate

SERVICE	ADDRESS	NOTE
Pump.fun	pump.fun	Research source, not a buying workflow for beginners (see Section 3.5)

Centralized exchanges — buy SOL with fiat, cash out to a bank

SERVICE	ADDRESS	NOTE
Coinbase	coinbase.com	Example exchange; availability varies by country
Kraken	kraken.com	Example exchange; availability varies by country
Binance	binance.com	Example exchange; availability varies by country
Bybit	bybit.com	Example exchange; availability varies by country

Before Using Any Of These

Phishing sites imitating every service above exist. Type the address yourself or use a bookmark you created after verifying the site — never a link from a message, reply, advertisement, or search result. Services, features, and country availability change over time; confirm current details on the service itself.

10.10 Solana Memecoin Research Sheet

A printable worksheet for one token. Complete it before deciding — if a field cannot be filled in, that blank is itself a finding.

TOKEN IDENTITY

Token name

Ticker

Mint address

Date researched

Sources mint verified against

MARKET DATA AT TIME OF RESEARCH

Market cap

FDV

Liquidity

24h volume

Unique traders

Pair age

SECURITY & OWNERSHIP

Mint authority

Freeze authority

LP locked / burned?

Top 10 concentration (%)

Wallet clusters observed

Creator wallet address

Creator wallet history

QUALITATIVE

Volume quality

Successful ordinary sells seen?

Community

Narrative

CONCLUSION

Main red flags

Main positive signals

Unresolved / unknown

Risk level

Exit conditions

Position size (if buying)



BUY

checks complete, exit planned



WATCH

unresolved items remain



WALK AWAY

disqualifying findings

Tick one. If any field above is blank, that blank is itself a finding — record it under “Unresolved / unknown” before deciding.

10.11 Before You Click Buy

The last page to read before any purchase. Every line should be a statement you can honestly make out loud.

- ☐ I verified the mint address against official sources.
- ☐ I checked the mint and freeze authorities.
- ☐ I checked holder concentration and looked for wallet clusters.
- ☐ I checked liquidity depth and LP status.
- ☐ I checked the creator wallet's history.
- ☐ I checked volume quality against unique traders.
- ☐ I confirmed ordinary wallets are able to sell.
- ☐ I checked the community for genuine engagement.
- ☐ I understand the narrative and why anyone cares.
- ☐ I know the main risks and what is still unresolved.
- ☐ I know the specific conditions under which I would exit.
- ☐ I am not buying because of FOMO.
- ☐ I am not relying on someone else's promise or recommendation.
- ☐ I can afford to lose the entire amount involved.

**IF YOU CANNOT EXPLAIN WHY YOU ARE BUYING IT,
DON'T BUY IT YET.**

The Final Test

If you cannot explain why you are buying it, don't buy it yet. A token you understand will still be there after you finish checking. A token that requires you to hurry was never offering you a fair choice.

10.12 Glossary

SOL

Solana's native currency, used for fees, trading, and rent.

SPL Token

The technical standard for all tokens on Solana other than SOL itself, including every memecoin.

Mint Address

A token's unique, permanent identifier on Solana.

Wallet

Software or hardware that stores your keys and signs transactions.

Recovery Phrase

12–24 words that can regenerate your wallet's private key; must never be shared.

Private Key

The cryptographic key that authorizes moving your funds.

DEX

Decentralized exchange — lets you swap tokens directly from your wallet.

Liquidity

The pool of paired assets that allows a token to be bought and sold.

Market Cap

Token price multiplied by circulating supply.

FDV

Fully diluted valuation — token price multiplied by total possible supply, including tokens not yet in circulation.

Volume

The amount of a token traded over a given time period.

Slippage

The tolerance for how much the executed price may differ from the quoted price.

Price Impact

How much your own trade moves the token's price.

Mint Authority

The ability to create new units of a token beyond its current supply.

Freeze Authority

The ability to freeze a specific wallet's token account.

Holder

A distinct wallet holding a balance of a given token.

LP

Liquidity pool, or liquidity provider — the mechanism/party supplying a trading pair's liquidity.

Rug Pull

A scam where a token's creator removes liquidity or dumps holdings, collapsing the price.

Honeypot

A token designed so buying works but selling is blocked or heavily restricted.

Bonding Curve

An automated pricing formula used by launchpads like Pump.fun before a token graduates to a standard DEX.

Pump.fun

A popular Solana token launchpad that lets anyone create a token quickly.

PumpSwap

The decentralized exchange where Pump.fun tokens commonly trade after graduating.

Token Account

A Solana account that holds a specific SPL token balance for a wallet.

Transaction Signature

A unique identifier for a specific on-chain transaction, used to look it up on an explorer.

Explorer

A public website (e.g. Solscan) used to look up wallets, tokens, and transactions on Solana.

MEV / Sniper (beginner explanation)

Automated strategies that trade ahead of or immediately around other transactions, often buying new tokens within seconds of launch.

YOU'VE REACHED THE END

Keep this guide close during your first several research sessions. The checklists in this section are designed to be used every time — not memorized once and abandoned.

BEFORE YOU START

Don't buy because someone told you to.

Research first.

Verify everything.

Understand the risk.

Have an exit plan.

The goal isn't to predict every memecoin.

The goal is to make better decisions.

Educational Disclaimer

Memecoins are highly speculative assets. You can lose some or all of the money you invest. This guide is for educational purposes only and does not constitute financial, investment, legal, or tax advice.

All interface images in this guide are illustrative mockups created for teaching purposes. They are not screenshots of any live product and do not represent real transactions, wallets, addresses, tokens, or performance data. Product names are referenced for identification only. Platform interfaces, features, and availability change over time — always confirm current details directly with the service you are using.